

ENGLISH FOR SALONS AND BARBERSHOPS

Hairdressing and Barbering English

Clear choices. Confident consultations.



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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For hairdressers, barbers, salon assistants, receptionists, and salon team leads.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight salon conversations: interpret a reference photo, compare shape and upkeep, discuss a color goal, reschedule a delayed appointment, pause for discomfort, explain optional services, review a result concern, and hand over future preferences.

01 Turning a reference photo into a clear request

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Keep the ponytail length | Separate a reference image into chosen and unchosen features, then confirm the agreed length before cutting.

02 Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

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The appointment no longer fits | Explain a delay, calculate the earliest ordinary finish, and offer a reschedule without promising a shortened service.

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Pause before the wash | Acknowledge discomfort, clarify the client description, and arrange a check without diagnosing or prescribing a position.

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07 Responding to a concern about the result

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The left side looks longer | Acknowledge a specific result concern, separate appearance from confirmed findings, and arrange review before promising a remedy.

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Agree on the feature, not just the name.

A useful consultation turns broad words and reference pictures into a shared understanding of length, shape, time, price, and permission. Clear language also leaves room to pause, assess suitability, or review a result without promising what has not been established.

A photo contains several choices

The client may want the outline but not the length or fringe. Ask which features matter and confirm the agreed plan before treating the whole picture as an instruction.

"The reference is chin-length, but our agreed outline is collarbone-length, with no fringe requested."

Appearance and technique differ

Explain the supplied visible contrast before using a style label. A photo does not establish which method is suitable for the client or how long daily styling will take.

"Photo A keeps visible hair over the sides; photo B exposes skin in its shortest area."

Assessment comes before assurance

A color goal, Friday deadline, or product name does not establish suitability, service duration, or cost. Record the relevant history and explain what remains to be assessed.

"Today is a consultation; the previous home-color product is still unknown."

A preference is not every permission

A retained length or no-spray request can be passed to reception. A future-service request is not a booking, and service consent is not permission for promotional photography.

"The consultation is requested but not booked, and no promotional-photo consent is recorded."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All salons, clients, prices, photographs described in words, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not cutting, chemical services, medical assessment, product testing, or legal requirements. Follow actual professional training, local rules, product instructions, consultation and consent procedures, and emergency arrangements. No example authorizes an unassessed chemical service, continuing through discomfort, or using a client image without the relevant permission.

Keep the ponytail length

A Read the situation

Separate a reference image into chosen and unchosen features, then confirm the agreed length before cutting.

Client Alex shows stylist Ren a photograph of a chin-length bob with a straight fringe. Alex likes the outline but wants enough length for a low ponytail. No cut has started. Through clarification, they agree to discuss a collarbone-length outline rather than copying the chin-length endpoint. Alex confirms that no fringe is requested. Ren must keep the visual reference, practical length requirement, and agreed plan distinct. The conversation does not guarantee that every strand will tie back or authorize other changes not specifically agreed.

PEOPLE / Alex: Client | Ren: Stylist

A PICTURE STARTS THE CONVERSATION

A client may expect a photograph to explain a preference but may not want every feature copied. Ask which part appeals to them, then point out any conflict with a practical requirement. Confirm the plan in ordinary length words before relying on technical style names.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What practical feature matters to Alex?

- A Copying every feature of the photo
- C A guaranteed chin-length cut today

- B A new straight fringe
- D Enough retained length for a low ponytail

2. Which endpoint is agreed for the outline discussion?

- A An unspecified amount removed
- C Chin length copied automatically

- B Collarbone length
- D Ear length

3. What is the fringe status?

- A It is mandatory for every bob
- C The photo automatically authorizes it

- B No fringe is requested
- D It has already been cut

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

consultation

Discussion to establish preferences, suitability, and the proposed service.

IN USE conduct a consultation

reference photo

Image used to communicate an idea, not automatically a complete instruction.

IN USE discuss the reference photo

bob

Short-to-medium haircut family with a defined outline, varying in length and shape.

IN USE clarify the bob outline

outline

Outer visible shape or boundary of the haircut.

IN USE confirm the outline

perimeter

Outer edge defining the haircut's overall length and shape.

IN USE discuss the perimeter

chin length

Length described relative to the chin.

IN USE distinguish chin length

collarbone length

Length described relative to the collarbone.

IN USE confirm collarbone length

retained length

Hair length kept rather than removed.

IN USE preserve retained length

low ponytail

Hair gathered and secured low at the back of the head.

IN USE retain low-ponytail length

fringe

Front hair shaped to fall over or around the forehead; also called bangs.

IN USE clarify the fringe

bangs

Common US term for a fringe.

IN USE explain bangs

straight fringe

Fringe with a visually straight outline across the front.

IN USE identify the straight fringe

Precision check

The photo has a chin-length endpoint and a straight fringe. Alex chooses neither automatically. The agreed outline discussion is collarbone-length, with no fringe requested and retained ponytail length as the practical requirement.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

face-framing

Hair shaped around the face as a distinct design feature.

IN USE discuss face-framing

front length

Length retained in the hair toward the face.

IN USE protect front length

side length

Length of hair at the sides of the head.

IN USE compare side length

back length

Length of hair at the back of the head.

IN USE confirm back length

parting

Line or division where hair is separated; also called a part.

IN USE identify the parting

blunt outline

Perimeter with a visually solid, even edge.

IN USE describe a blunt outline

layers

Hair lengths arranged at different levels within a haircut.

IN USE discuss layers

trim

Removal of a limited amount, which still needs an agreed length.

IN USE clarify the trim

length removal

Amount of hair to be cut off.

IN USE confirm length removal

visual feature

Specific visible aspect of the reference or proposed result.

IN USE identify a visual feature

agreed plan

Service details explicitly confirmed with the client.

IN USE repeat the agreed plan

consent

Permission for the specified action, not every possible variation.

IN USE confirm service consent

Precision check

A trim, a bob, and enough to tie back can mean different things to different people. Use an agreed visible length reference and check the actual hair before making a promise about how every section will behave.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE REFERENCE

"Which features of this photograph do you like?"

IDENTIFY THE VISIBLE ENDPOINT

"The photograph shows a chin-length bob."

NAME THE REQUIREMENT

"Keeping enough length for a low ponytail matters to you."

KEEP THE FRINGE SEPARATE

"The photo has a straight fringe; is that part of your request?"

SEPARATE LENGTH AND SHAPE

"Do you want the outline, the length, or both?"

ASK ABOUT DAILY USE

"Do you need to be able to tie it back?"

PROPOSE THE LONGER OUTLINE

"Shall we discuss a collarbone-length outline instead?"

RECORD THE EXCLUSION

"No fringe is requested."

Reference versus instruction

A reference suggests features; the client must confirm which ones are intended.

At versus off

Length at the collarbone describes the endpoint; an amount off describes removal.

Fringe and bangs

These regional terms can refer to the same front feature.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM BEFORE CUTTING

"Let us agree on the length before any cut begins."

CLARIFY FRONT LENGTH

"How much front length do you want retained?"

AVOID AN ABSOLUTE PROMISE

"I cannot promise every strand will tie back from the photo alone."

READ BACK THE PLAN

"Collarbone-length outline, retained ponytail length, no fringe."

AVOID COPYING EVERYTHING

"The photo is a reference, not permission for every feature."

CHECK THE OUTLINE

"Is this the shape you mean?"

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please stop me if I have misunderstood the priority."

CLOSE THE CONSULTATION POINT

"That is the agreed direction, with no cut started yet."

Enough for

This expresses a practical requirement that needs checking against the actual hair.

Instead

Instead marks the agreed longer endpoint replacing the photo's shorter one.

No cut started

Clarification occurs before the irreversible action, leaving room to correct the plan.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back preserves the agreement?

- A** Copy everything because a photo was shown
- B** Collarbone-length outline, retain ponytail length, no fringe
- C** Chin-length with the photo's fringe
- D** Remove all front length automatically

2. Which feature needs separate consent?

- A** The fact that the photo exists
- B** The word collarbone
- C** Alex's stated wish to keep length
- D** The straight fringe shown in the photo

3. What does trim fail to specify on its own?

- A** The salon's name
- B** The agreed amount or endpoint of length removal
- C** That hair exists
- D** Whether the client is speaking

4. Which promise is unsupported?

- A** No fringe is requested.
- B** Every strand will definitely fit into a ponytail based only on this photo.
- C** No cut has started.
- D** The reference shows a chin-length bob.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Keep the ponytail length

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

agreed plan / length removal / retained length / reference photo / consent / low ponytail / collarbone-length / fringe / outline / visual feature

- 01 **Alex:** I brought this picture because I like the bob shape. I do need to keep enough length for a low ponytail, though.
- 02 **Ren:** Let us separate the features in the ¹ _____. Which part appeals to you most: the outline, the chin-length endpoint, or the front fringe?
- 03 **Alex:** Mainly the outline. I had not really thought about how short the chin length would feel when I tried to tie it back.
- 04 **Ren:** Then your ² _____ requirement is important. We should not copy the shorter endpoint simply because it appears in the picture you brought.
- 05 **Alex:** Exactly. I like a defined shape, but tying it back for work matters more than matching the photograph strand for strand.
- 06 **Ren:** We can discuss a ³ _____ outline instead. That gives us a different length reference to agree on, rather than assuming the chin-length version is your instruction.
- 07 **Alex:** That sounds closer to what I want. Please keep the ponytail requirement in the plan when we discuss the front and sides too.
- 08 **Ren:** I will. A ⁴ _____ is your stated priority, and we need to check the actual lengths rather than make a promise from this photograph alone.
- 09 **Alex:** There is one thing in the picture I definitely do not want: the straight hair across the forehead. I do not want that added.
- 10 **Ren:** That is the ⁵ _____, also called bangs. I will record no fringe requested, so the photograph does not accidentally become permission to add one.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Alex:** Thank you. I have heard both words and was not sure whether they always meant something different. Now I know which feature we are discussing.
- 12 **Ren:** Yes. We are identifying the ⁶ _____ rather than relying on the label alone. Your choice here is to leave that feature out of the request.
- 13 **Alex:** Could you also explain outline? I understand the general idea, but I want to be certain it is not another word for shortening everything equally.
- 14 **Ren:** The ⁷ _____ is the outer visible shape of the haircut. We can discuss that shape separately from the amount removed in each area.
- 15 **Alex:** That helps. I want a clear shape at the longer length we mentioned, with enough retained length for the practical way I wear it.
- 16 **Ren:** Let me repeat the ⁸ _____: collarbone-length outline, keeping your ponytail requirement central, and no fringe requested. Have I understood the priorities correctly?
- 17 **Alex:** Yes. I am glad we checked before starting. I would not want the shorter length or the fringe copied simply because they were in the image.
- 18 **Ren:** That is why we confirm ⁹ _____ for the specific plan. A photograph can contain several choices, and they do not all become part of your service automatically.
- 19 **Alex:** Please keep discussing any other change with me before doing it. I would rather ask another question now than discover a misunderstanding afterward.
- 20 **Ren:** Certainly. No cut has started, and we will clarify any further ¹⁰ _____ before proceeding. We have the outline direction and your priorities, without adding an unrequested fringe or promising every strand will tie back.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. reference photo | 2. retained length | 3. collarbone-length | 4. low ponytail | 5. fringe | 6. visual feature | 7. outline | 8. agreed plan | 9. consent | 10. length removal

Confirm another reference-photo request

F Say it

A client shows an ear-length reference but agrees to a shoulder-length outline. The client wants front length retained and explicitly declines bangs. No cut has started.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

front / shoulder-length / bangs / started

Stylist: "The agreed outline is ¹ _____."

Client: "Please retain the ² _____ length."

Stylist: "No ³ _____ are requested."

Client: "The cut has not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. shoulder-length | 2. front | 3. bangs | 4. started

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Less bulk, not bare sides

A Read the situation

Compare visible features, clarify an everyday styling limit, and distinguish a style label from an agreed result.

Client Morgan wants less fullness at the neckline but no exposed skin at the sides. Barber Dev has two reference photographs. Photo A, labelled low taper, shows visible hair covering the sides. Photo B, labelled skin fade, shows exposed skin at the shortest area of the sides. Morgan spends five minutes styling each morning. Dev compares only these supplied appearances. No cutting method, exact length, or guaranteed maintenance time has been agreed. Morgan prefers the covered-side appearance of A, while keeping the neckline concern separate.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Client | Dev: Barber

COMPARE WHAT BOTH PEOPLE CAN SEE

Style names can vary between shops, images, and clients. Anchor the comparison in visible features rather than insisting that one label settles the request. A daily time limit expresses a preference; it does not prove a proposed style will meet it.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Morgan want at the neckline?

- A An agreed cutting technique
- C Less fullness

- B A guaranteed daily result
- D More exposed skin at the sides

2. Which supplied photo shows covered sides?

- A Neither has been described
- C Photo B

- B Photo A
- D Both show bare sides

3. How much daily styling time does Morgan report?

- A Forty minutes
- C Twenty minutes

- B Five minutes
- D No time limit is mentioned

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fullness

Visual amount of hair or volume in an area.

IN USE reduce neckline fullness

bulk

Perceived density or weight in a section of hair.

IN USE clarify unwanted bulk

neckline

Lower outline of the hair at the back of the neck.

IN USE discuss the neckline

nape

Back portion of the neck near the lower hairline.

IN USE identify the nape

taper

Gradual change in hair length; the intended appearance still needs clarification.

IN USE discuss a taper

low taper

Style label suggesting a low-positioned transition, interpreted with a reference.

IN USE clarify the low taper

fade

Gradual transition between shorter and longer hair lengths.

IN USE compare fade references

skin fade

Fade whose shortest area exposes skin in the supplied reference.

IN USE identify the skin fade

transition

Visible change from one length or appearance to another.

IN USE describe the transition

blend

Visual merging of different hair lengths or areas.

IN USE discuss the blend

exposed skin

Skin visible where the supplied reference has very short hair.

IN USE avoid exposed skin

coverage

Visible hair remaining over an area.

IN USE retain side coverage

Precision check

Photo A and photo B are defined by their supplied appearances. A keeps visible hair over the sides; B exposes skin at the shortest area. Morgan chooses the covered-side appearance, not every feature associated with the label.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sideburn

Hair extending down in front of the ear.

IN USE clarify sideburn length

crown

Area toward the upper back of the head.

IN USE identify the crown

hairline

Boundary where hair growth meets visible skin.

IN USE describe the hairline

natural texture

Hair's own visible or tactile pattern and behavior.

IN USE discuss natural texture

density

Amount of hair growing within an area.

IN USE assess hair density

strand thickness

Thickness of an individual hair, distinct from overall density.

IN USE distinguish strand thickness

growth pattern

Direction or arrangement in which hair naturally grows.

IN USE discuss the growth pattern

cowlick

Area where growth direction makes hair stand or turn differently.

IN USE identify a cowlick

finish

Final styled appearance following the service.

IN USE compare the finish

styling routine

Usual steps and time used to arrange hair.

IN USE describe the styling routine

upkeep

Ongoing effort or appointments needed to maintain an appearance.

IN USE discuss upkeep

visual comparison

Comparison of observable features rather than assumptions about technique.

IN USE make a visual comparison

Precision check

Hair density concerns the amount of hair in an area; strand thickness concerns individual hairs. Neither a photo nor a style name establishes Morgan's actual hair characteristics, suitable cutting method, or guaranteed daily maintenance time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE PRIORITY

"You want less fullness at the neckline."

COMPARE THE REFERENCES

"Photo A keeps visible hair over the sides."

CHECK THE LABEL

"When you say taper, is this the appearance you mean?"

ASK ABOUT ROUTINE

"How much time do you usually spend styling it?"

KEEP THE EXCLUSION CLEAR

"You do not want exposed skin at the sides."

DESCRIBE THE CONTRAST

"Photo B exposes skin in its shortest area."

SEPARATE THE AREAS

"Let us discuss the neckline separately from the sides."

RECORD THE TIME LIMIT

"You have about five minutes each morning."

Less versus none

Less fullness does not mean removing all hair from an area.

At versus on

At the neckline identifies a boundary; on the sides identifies a broader area.

Covered versus exposed

These describe the visible difference relevant to this client's preference.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"I cannot promise that routine from the photograph alone."

AVOID TECHNICAL ASSUMPTIONS

"We have not agreed on a cutting method yet."

CLARIFY BULK

"Where does the fullness bother you most?"

READ BACK THE APPEARANCE

"Less neckline fullness, with visible hair covering the sides."

CLARIFY COVERAGE

"Is keeping the sides covered the important feature?"

ASK FOR A VISIBLE COMPARISON

"Which of these side appearances is closer to your preference?"

CHECK THE NATURAL PATTERN

"We still need to assess how your hair grows."

CONFIRM THE BOUNDARY

"Choosing A does not mean copying every detail."

Label versus reference

A style label helps discussion but does not replace an agreed visual description.

Time budget

Five minutes states available effort, not a verified styling outcome.

Separate priorities

Neckline fullness and side coverage can be discussed without treating them as one decision.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is supported?

- A** Every low taper looks identical.
- B** B guarantees five-minute styling.
- C** A authorizes every cutting method.
- D** A shows covered sides; B shows exposed skin at the shortest area.

2. Which clarification best follows less bulk?

- A** Why do you want all the sides shaved?
- B** Shall I assume no hair remains?
- C** Is your appointment tomorrow?
- D** Where does the fullness bother you most?

3. What remains unagreed?

- A** Morgan's five-minute routine
- B** The dislike of exposed sides
- C** Photo A's described coverage
- D** The cutting method and exact length

4. Which summary preserves both preferences?

- A** Reduce neckline fullness while retaining visible side coverage.
- B** Expose the sides because the neckline is bulky.
- C** Copy B because both images are short.
- D** Promise no upkeep after choosing A.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

Less bulk, not bare sides

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

bulk / appearance / growth pattern / Exposed skin / coverage / upkeep / neckline / visual comparison / time budget / styling routine

- 01 **Morgan:** The back feels too full around my collar, but I do not want bare sides. I have had that misunderstood before.
- 02 **Dev:** Let us separate the ¹ _____ from the sides. We can compare the visible features in these two pictures before assuming a style name explains everything.
- 03 **Morgan:** The first picture looks closer. The second one is much shorter at the sides than I would feel comfortable wearing.
- 04 **Dev:** In photo A, labelled low taper, there is visible ² _____ over the sides. Photo B has exposed skin in its shortest side area.
- 05 **Morgan:** Then A is the direction I mean. I do not want the shortest area from B added just because I ask for less fullness.
- 06 **Dev:** Understood. ³ _____ is not part of your request. The neckline concern does not override that boundary, and choosing A does not select every detail.
- 07 **Morgan:** Is taper the word I should use next time? I thought it meant what I wanted, but another person understood it differently.
- 08 **Dev:** It can help, but a ⁴ _____ is clearer here. Pointing out covered sides and the area of unwanted fullness gives us more precise information than the label alone.
- 09 **Morgan:** That makes sense. The fullness bothers me where the hair meets my collar, rather than across the whole back of my head.
- 10 **Dev:** I will record the unwanted ⁵ _____ in that location. We still need to agree on the exact length and assess the actual hair before choosing a method.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Morgan:** I also have only five minutes in the morning. I cannot spend a long time trying to reproduce a photograph every day.
- 12 **Dev:** Your ⁶ _____ is an important part of the discussion. Five minutes is your available time, not something I can guarantee from a reference image.
- 13 **Morgan:** Please do not assume I use a dryer or several products. I would rather explain my routine before we settle the final plan.
- 14 **Dev:** Certainly. We can discuss ⁷ _____ alongside appearance. The photograph does not show the person's daily routine, products, or how their hair naturally behaves.
- 15 **Morgan:** So the photo helps us compare the sides, but it does not tell you exactly how my hair will sit after the appointment.
- 16 **Dev:** Correct. Your ⁸ _____ and other hair characteristics still matter. We have not established those details by looking at someone else's hairstyle.
- 17 **Morgan:** Let me check the main point: I prefer A's covered sides, and I want less fullness at the neckline near my collar.
- 18 **Dev:** Yes. That is the agreed ⁹ _____ for discussion. It does not yet specify an exact length or technique, and it does not include the exposed side area in B.
- 19 **Morgan:** Good. I would like those details checked with me before anything starts, especially if a proposed change would affect how covered the sides look.
- 20 **Dev:** We will confirm the remaining details before proceeding. Your five-minute ¹⁰ _____ stays in the consultation, alongside the neckline priority and the clear preference for visible hair over the sides.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. neckline | 2. coverage | 3. Exposed skin | 4. visual comparison | 5. bulk | 6. styling routine | 7. upkeep | 8. growth pattern | 9. appearance | 10. time budget

Compare another pair of references

F Say it

Photo C shows hair covering the sides. Photo D shows exposed skin at the shortest side area. The client chooses C, dislikes fullness at the nape, and has ten minutes for daily styling. No method is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ten / C / nape / method

Barber: "The client prefers photo ¹ _____."

Client: "The unwanted fullness is at the ² _____."

Barber: "The daily time budget is ³ _____ minutes."

Client: "No cutting ⁴ _____ has been agreed."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. C | 2. nape | 3. ten | 4. method

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A cool tone by Friday?

A Read the situation

03

Clarify a color goal and previous-product uncertainty while explaining what a consultation has not yet established.

Client Priya wants the cool color tone in a photograph before Friday. Colorist Ellis is conducting a consultation only today. Priya used a home-color product previously but cannot identify it. Suitability, service duration, and cost have not been assessed, and no color appointment is booked. Ellis distinguishes the desired tonal character from the lightness or darkness of the reference. The conversation records the unknown product and the deadline without promising a formula, exact photographic match, or completion by Friday.

PEOPLE / Priya: Client | Ellis: Colorist

TRANSLATE THE GOAL WITHOUT SELLING CERTAINTY

A client may use brighter, lighter, warmer, and fresher interchangeably. Clarify the visible quality they mean before using technical language. A deadline can guide planning, but it cannot replace assessment of the service, product history, time, and cost.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is booked today?

- A** A confirmed product test
- B** A consultation only
- C** A completed color service
- D** A guaranteed Friday transformation

2. Which history detail remains unknown?

- A** The previous home-color product
- B** Whether Priya brought a photo
- C** The requested Friday deadline
- D** The preference for a cool tone

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** No color appointment is booked.
- B** The photographed result will be completed by Friday.
- C** The client wants a cool tone.
- D** Cost has not been assessed.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

color consultation

Discussion and assessment before a possible color service.

IN USE book a color consultation

color goal

Desired color appearance, subject to assessment.

IN USE clarify the color goal

level

Relative lightness or darkness of hair color.

IN USE discuss the color level

tone

Color character such as warm or cool, distinct from lightness.

IN USE clarify the tone

cool tone

Tonal family associated with cooler color character.

IN USE identify a cool tone

warm tone

Tonal family associated with warmer color character.

IN USE describe a warm tone

ash

Salon term for a cool tonal direction; naming systems vary.

IN USE discuss an ash tone

golden

Term describing a warm gold tonal character.

IN USE identify golden tones

base color

Main underlying or overall color being discussed.

IN USE clarify the base color

regrowth

Hair grown since a previous color service.

IN USE discuss visible regrowth

color history

Record of previous coloring products and services.

IN USE review color history

home color

Hair-color product applied outside the salon setting.

IN USE identify previous home color

Precision check

Level describes lightness or darkness; tone describes color character. A cool reference tone does not identify a suitable product, establish a formula, or show that the same result can be achieved on Priya's hair by Friday.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

product identity

Exact name and identifying information of a product.

IN USE confirm product identity

permanent color

Product category designed for lasting color change.

IN USE distinguish permanent color

demi-permanent color

Color category distinct from permanent and temporary products; details vary.

IN USE clarify demi-permanent color

semi-permanent color

Color category generally intended to fade over washes; details vary.

IN USE discuss semi-permanent color

temporary color

Product category intended for short-lived color effects.

IN USE identify temporary color

lightener

Product category used to lighten hair, requiring professional assessment.

IN USE discuss a lightener service

toner

Product or service used to adjust tonal character.

IN USE clarify a toner service

highlights

Selected areas made visibly lighter than surrounding hair.

IN USE discuss highlights

balayage

Term associated with hand-painted color placement.

IN USE clarify balayage expectations

color correction

Service addressing an unwanted or uneven color result.

IN USE assess color correction

suitability

Whether a proposed service is appropriate after assessment.

IN USE assess service suitability

service estimate

Provisional statement of expected time or cost.

IN USE provide a service estimate

Precision check

Unknown is a useful, accurate history entry. Do not relabel an unidentified home product as temporary or harmless. Product names, instructions, warnings, professional assessment, and relevant checks must be handled through actual salon procedures.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CLARIFY THE ATTRACTION

"Is it the cool tone or the lighter level that you like?"

EXPLAIN TONE

"Tone describes the color character, such as warm or cool."

ASK ABOUT HISTORY

"Which home-color product did you use?"

AVOID GUESSING A CATEGORY

"I cannot assume it was temporary color."

EXPLAIN LEVEL

"Level describes how light or dark the color is."

SET TODAY'S SCOPE

"Today is a consultation only."

RECORD UNCERTAINTY

"The previous product is not yet identified."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DEADLINE

"I understand you would prefer it before Friday."

By versus before

Both express deadline expectations; neither confirms the salon can meet them.

Lighter versus cooler

Lighter concerns level, while cooler concerns tonal character.

Not yet

This marks an unfinished assessment rather than a permanent refusal.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

SEPARATE GOAL AND PROMISE

"The photo shows your goal, not a confirmed result."

NAME THE PENDING ASSESSMENT

"Suitability has not yet been assessed."

KEEP TIME PROVISIONAL

"We have not established the service duration."

KEEP PRICE PROVISIONAL

"We have not assessed the cost yet."

CLARIFY BOOKING STATUS

"No color appointment is booked."

AVOID A FORMULA PROMISE

"We have not selected a product or formula."

CONFIRM THE NEXT DISCUSSION

"We need the relevant history before confirming the service plan."

SUMMARIZE ACCURATELY

"Cool-tone goal, unknown previous product, consultation only."

Unknown versus none

Unknown previous product does not mean no previous coloring occurred.

Goal versus result

A desired appearance is not evidence of an achievable exact match.

Estimate versus quote

An estimate is provisional; use the salon's actual terms for confirmed prices.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation distinguishes level and tone?

- A** Both mean appointment length.
- B** Tone means the product price.
- C** Level guarantees suitability.
- D** Level is lightness or darkness; tone is color character.

2. Which history entry is accurate?

- A** Previous home-color product not identified.
- B** No previous color used.
- C** Temporary product confirmed.
- D** Permanent product confirmed.

3. Which response handles the deadline accurately?

- A** I understand Friday matters; we have not assessed whether that is achievable.
- B** Friday is guaranteed because you have a photo.
- C** All color goals take the same time.
- D** Consultation means treatment starts today.

4. Which status should reception receive?

- A** Consultation only; no color appointment booked.
- B** Friday color service confirmed.
- C** Exact formula selected and approved.
- D** Price accepted and paid.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

A cool tone by Friday?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

color goal / level / cost / product identity / Suitability / booking status / home color / service duration / color consultation / Tone

- 01 **Priya:** I love the cool color in this picture. I have an event on Friday, and I was hoping I could have it done before then.
- 02 **Ellis:** I understand the timing. Today is a ¹ _____, so we will clarify the goal and the relevant history before confirming what service might be appropriate.
- 03 **Priya:** Is cool the right word? I like that it does not look golden. I am less certain about whether I want it lighter.
- 04 **Ellis:** That helps. ² _____ describes that color character. We can discuss the cool quality separately from how light or dark you want the overall result.
- 05 **Priya:** Then I should not just say I want the same color and expect you to understand every part of the photograph.
- 06 **Ellis:** Exactly. The ³ _____ is the lightness or darkness. The picture gives us a starting point, but those two preferences still need their own discussion.
- 07 **Priya:** I used a color from a shop at home a while ago. I do not remember the name or what type it was.
- 08 **Ellis:** I will record the previous ⁴ _____ as unidentified. We should not assume it was temporary, or say there was no previous color, simply because the name is missing.
- 09 **Priya:** I may have the packaging somewhere. Would the exact name be more useful than my memory of the color on the box?
- 10 **Ellis:** Yes, accurate ⁵ _____ is useful for the assessment. For now, the honest record is that you used a product but cannot identify it.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Priya:** Does that mean you cannot tell me today that I will leave on Friday looking exactly like the photograph?
- 12 **Ellis:** Correct. ⁶ _____ has not been assessed, and the photograph does not establish how your hair will respond. I cannot promise that exact result or deadline.
- 13 **Priya:** I appreciate knowing that before I plan around it. I also need to understand how much time I would have to set aside.
- 14 **Ellis:** We have not established the ⁷ _____ yet. It depends on the plan after assessment, so I do not want you to treat a guessed length of appointment as confirmed.
- 15 **Priya:** And the price? I have seen very different prices for color services, and I do not know which description applies to my request.
- 16 **Ellis:** The ⁸ _____ has not been assessed either. We need to clarify the proposed service before discussing a meaningful amount, rather than selecting a price from the photograph alone.
- 17 **Priya:** That is clear. Please keep the cool-tone preference in the notes, but do not book a service on the assumption that I have accepted it.
- 18 **Ellis:** I will record your ⁹ _____ and the unknown product history. No product or formula has been selected, and no color appointment is booked.
- 19 **Priya:** Good. Friday is my preference, but I understand it is not a commitment from the salon. We still need to discuss the actual plan.
- 20 **Ellis:** Exactly. The ¹⁰ _____ remains consultation only. We will keep the deadline, tonal preference, product uncertainty, and pending time and cost assessment separate in the record.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. color consultation | 2. Tone | 3. level | 4. home color | 5. product identity | 6. Suitability | 7. service duration | 8. cost | 9. color goal | 10. booking status

Keep another color request provisional

F Say it

A client requests a warmer tone for a future event. The previous product is unidentified. Today is consultation only, and neither duration nor price is assessed. No future service is booked.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unidentified / consultation / booked / warmer

Colorist: "The requested tonal direction is ¹ _____."

Client: "My previous product remains ² _____."

Colorist: "Today is a ³ _____ only."

Reception: "No future service is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. warmer | 2. unidentified | 3. consultation | 4. booked

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The appointment no longer fits

A Read the situation

Explain a delay, calculate the earliest ordinary finish, and offer a reschedule without promising a shortened service.

Receptionist Hana tells client Luis that the 2:00 haircut appointment is running twenty minutes late. The usual service duration is forty minutes, while Luis must leave by 2:45. A 2:20 start would ordinarily finish at 3:00, so the appointment no longer fits the departure requirement. A 10:00 appointment tomorrow is available. This fictional salon waives the change fee when its own delay causes this rescheduling. Luis chooses tomorrow at 10:00, and Hana confirms the replacement appointment without keeping today as an active second booking.

PEOPLE / Luis: Client | Hana: Receptionist

AN APOLOGY NEEDS USEFUL INFORMATION

A brief apology works best with a specific delay, its effect on the client, and a workable option. Do not pressure someone to accept a rushed service because they have already arrived. Explain the relevant local fee rule without presenting it as universal.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the revised start based on the stated delay?

A 2:00

B 2:45

C 3:20

D 2:20

2. When would the ordinary forty-minute service finish?

A 3:00

B 2:40

C 2:45

D 3:20

3. Which replacement does Luis choose?

A Both appointments remain active

B An unspecified later day

C Tomorrow at 10:00

D Today at 2:45

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

appointment slot

Specific time reserved for a service.

IN USE confirm the appointment slot

scheduled start

Originally planned beginning time.

IN USE state the scheduled start

delay

Difference between the planned and later expected start.

IN USE explain the delay

revised start

Updated beginning time following a change.

IN USE confirm the revised start

service duration

Amount of time normally allocated to the service.

IN USE state the service duration

estimated finish

Expected ending time based on available information.

IN USE calculate the estimated finish

departure deadline

Latest time the client must leave.

IN USE respect the departure deadline

time conflict

Incompatibility between two timing requirements.

IN USE identify the time conflict

availability

Whether a slot can currently be offered.

IN USE check tomorrow's availability

reschedule

Move an appointment to a different time.

IN USE reschedule the haircut

replacement booking

New appointment taking the place of the original.

IN USE confirm the replacement booking

cancellation

Removal of an appointment from the schedule.

IN USE record the cancellation

Precision check

The delay changes the start, not the service duration. A 2:20 start plus forty minutes gives 3:00, fifteen minutes after the client must leave. Do not imply the ordinary service can simply fit into twenty-five minutes.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

change fee

Charge associated with altering a booking under a stated policy.

IN USE explain the change fee

fee waiver

Decision not to charge an otherwise applicable fee.

IN USE apply the fee waiver

salon-caused delay

Delay originating from the salon's schedule or operations.

IN USE acknowledge the salon-caused delay

late arrival

Client reaching the appointment after its scheduled start.

IN USE distinguish a late arrival

no-show

Failure to attend without the required notice under a local policy.

IN USE clarify the no-show category

notice period

Required advance time for a change under a specified policy.

IN USE explain the notice period

confirmation message

Written or spoken statement of agreed booking details.

IN USE send a confirmation message

booking record

Stored appointment details and status.

IN USE update the booking record

duplicate booking

Two appointments unintentionally active for the same intended service.

IN USE avoid a duplicate booking

waitlist

List of clients seeking a slot if one becomes available.

IN USE explain the waitlist

service allocation

Time assigned to carry out the planned service.

IN USE preserve the service allocation

calendar date

Specific day identified by date, not only a relative term.

IN USE confirm the calendar date

Precision check

This salon waives the change fee because its delay caused the rescheduling. That is a supplied local policy, not a claim about every salon. Confirm the actual date and replacement status when making a real booking.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DELAY

"I am sorry; your appointment is running twenty minutes late."

ASK ABOUT THE LIMIT

"What time do you need to leave?"

EXPLAIN THE ARITHMETIC

"A 2:20 start would ordinarily finish at 3:00."

AVOID A RUSHED PROMISE

"I cannot promise a shortened service to make it fit."

STATE THE REVISED START

"The revised start is 2:20."

STATE THE ORDINARY DURATION

"We normally allow forty minutes for this service."

NAME THE CONFLICT

"That would be after your 2:45 departure deadline."

OFFER A CONCRETE ALTERNATIVE

"We have 10:00 tomorrow available."

Running late

This describes schedule delay without necessarily blaming the client.

At versus by

At 2:20 gives a start; by 2:45 gives a latest departure.

Duration versus delay

Forty minutes is service time; twenty minutes is the delay.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN THE LOCAL POLICY

"We waive the change fee when our delay causes this rescheduling."

CONFIRM ACCEPTANCE

"You would like tomorrow at 10:00 instead."

AVOID A DUPLICATE

"Today's slot will not remain as a second active booking."

DOCUMENT THE REASON

"I will record the salon-caused delay."

INVITE THE CHOICE

"Would you like the appointment moved to that slot?"

REPLACE THE ORIGINAL

"I will make this the replacement for today's appointment."

READ BACK DETAILS

"Let us confirm the date, time, and service together."

CLOSE WITH A CHECK

"Please check that the confirmation shows the agreed replacement."

Instead

Tomorrow's slot replaces today's rather than adding a second service.

Waive versus refund

Waiving a fee means not charging it; refunding returns money already paid.

Relative dates

Tomorrow is clear in conversation but a real confirmation should identify the actual date.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is accurate?

- A** Forty minutes after 2:20 is 2:40.
- B** Starting at 2:20 would ordinarily finish at 3:00, after your departure deadline.
- C** Twenty minutes late means the service lasts twenty minutes.
- D** A 2:20 start guarantees a 2:45 finish.

2. Why is the change fee waived here?

- A** Luis arrived late.
- B** All tomorrow appointments are free.
- C** The salon's delay causes the rescheduling under its stated policy.
- D** Every salon is legally required to waive every fee.

3. Which booking record is correct after acceptance?

- A** Both slots remain active without discussion.
- B** Today is marked completed.
- C** Tomorrow remains unconfirmed despite the read-back.
- D** Tomorrow 10:00 replaces today's appointment.

4. Which response should be avoided?

- A** Tomorrow at 10:00 is available.
- B** The ordinary finish would be 3:00.
- C** We will definitely compress the forty-minute service into twenty-five minutes.
- D** I am sorry about the delay.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

The appointment no longer fits

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

departure deadline / duplicate booking / service duration / availability / replacement booking / revised start / fee waiver / booking record / confirmation message / delay

- 01 **Luis:** I am here for my two o'clock haircut. Before I sit down, I should mention that I have to leave by quarter to three.
- 02 **Hana:** I am sorry, but we have a twenty-minute ¹ _____ today. I want to explain the timing clearly so you can decide whether another appointment would work better.
- 03 **Luis:** Thank you for telling me. Does that mean I would start at twenty past two, or is that when the haircut would be finished?
- 04 **Hana:** Twenty past two is the ² _____. We normally allow forty minutes for this service, so it would not be finished at that point.
- 05 **Luis:** Then I think we have a problem. I cannot move the time I need to leave, and I do not want to be watching the clock throughout.
- 06 **Hana:** I understand. With the usual ³ _____, the ordinary finish would be three o'clock. That is fifteen minutes after you need to leave.
- 07 **Luis:** Could it be made shorter, or would that mean promising something the stylist has not actually agreed to do? I would rather know now.
- 08 **Hana:** I cannot promise a shortened service to meet your ⁴ _____. The straightforward alternative is to move the appointment to a time that allows the normal service allocation.
- 09 **Luis:** What do you have tomorrow? If there is a morning appointment, that would probably be easier than trying to make today work.
- 10 **Hana:** There is ⁵ _____ at ten tomorrow morning. We can discuss moving your haircut to that slot rather than keeping you waiting for a service that conflicts with your schedule.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Luis:** Ten works for me. Would I have to pay a change fee even though the appointment is moving because the salon is behind?
- 12 **Hana:** Under our stated policy, we apply a ⁶ _____ when our delay causes this rescheduling. You will not be charged that change fee for moving this appointment.
- 13 **Luis:** All right, please move it to ten tomorrow. I would prefer that to rushing today or being late for my next commitment.
- 14 **Hana:** I will confirm the ⁷ _____ for tomorrow at ten. Today's appointment will no longer remain as an active second booking for the same service.
- 15 **Luis:** Good. I sometimes get two reminders after an appointment changes, and then I am unsure which one I am supposed to attend.
- 16 **Hana:** I will check the ⁸ _____ when making the change. The record should show the agreed replacement and the salon-caused reason for rescheduling.
- 17 **Luis:** Could we read the details back before I go? I want to be certain I have heard the time correctly and that it is still the haircut.
- 18 **Hana:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ should show the actual date for tomorrow, ten o'clock, and the haircut service. We will check those details together.
- 19 **Luis:** That is what I want. Thank you for explaining the finish time instead of just asking me to wait another twenty minutes.
- 20 **Hana:** You are welcome, and I am sorry for the disruption. We have avoided a ¹⁰ _____ and agreed on the new slot, with the change fee waived under our policy for this delay.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. delay | 2. revised start | 3. service duration | 4. departure deadline | 5. availability | 6. fee waiver | 7. replacement booking | 8. booking record | 9. confirmation message | 10. duplicate booking

Calculate a different scheduling conflict

F Say it

A 1:00 appointment is delayed to 1:15. Its usual duration is forty-five minutes. The client must leave at 1:50 and accepts a 9:30 replacement tomorrow. The salon waives the change fee for its own delay.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

2:00 / waived / 9:30 / ten

Reception: "The ordinary finish would be ¹ _____."

Client: "That is ² _____ minutes after my departure deadline."

Reception: "Tomorrow's replacement is at ³ _____."

Reception: "The change fee is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. 2:00 | 2. ten | 3. 9:30 | 4. waived

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Pause before the wash

A Read the situation

Acknowledge discomfort, clarify the client description, and arrange a check without diagnosing or prescribing a position.

05

Before a wash begins, client Sam tells salon assistant Imani that the neck support feels uncomfortable. Water has not started. Sam describes pressure at the back of the neck where it meets the support. Imani pauses preparation and asks lead stylist Noor to review the comfort concern through the salon process. Sam agrees to that check but does not agree to resume the wash yet. No cause, injury, medical condition, or appropriate body position is established by this conversation.

PEOPLE / Sam: Client | Imani: Salon assistant

A PAUSE IS A SERVICE RESPONSE

Some clients minimize discomfort because they do not want to interrupt the appointment. Respond plainly and respectfully when they speak up. Agreement to a comfort check is not the same as agreement to restart; ask about the specific next step.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has not started?

A The request for a comfort check

B The water and wash

C The client's description

D The preparation pause

2. Where does Sam describe pressure?

A Across the forehead

B Only at the wrist

C At the back of the neck against the support

D Inside the ear

3. What does Sam agree to?

A Immediate restart without a check

B A medical diagnosis

C A prescribed new body position

D A comfort check, not restarting the wash

Answers and explanations: page 84.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

wash station

Area equipped for washing a client's hair.

IN USE identify the wash station

basin

Bowl at the wash station.

IN USE refer to the basin

neck support

Surface or fitting supporting the neck at the basin.

IN USE check the neck support

contact point

Place where the body touches a support or surface.

IN USE identify the contact point

pressure

Sensation of force against an area, described by the client.

IN USE describe the pressure

discomfort

Unpleasant sensation that the client reports.

IN USE acknowledge discomfort

comfort check

Review of the client's comfort before proceeding.

IN USE arrange a comfort check

preparation

Work done before the wash itself starts.

IN USE pause preparation

pause

Temporary stop pending clarification or a check.

IN USE keep the wash paused

resume

Begin again after a pause with the required agreement.

IN USE confirm before resuming

consent to continue

Agreement to proceed with a specific next action.

IN USE ask for consent to continue

client report

The client's own account of a sensation or concern.

IN USE preserve the client report

Precision check

Sam reports pressure where the neck meets the support. That description is not a diagnosis. The water has not started, preparation is paused, and Noor is asked to review the concern before any decision to continue.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

location

Specific area where the sensation is felt.

IN USE clarify the location

onset

When a sensation began, without diagnosing its cause.

IN USE ask about onset

intensity

How strong a sensation feels to the client.

IN USE clarify reported intensity

persistent

Continuing rather than stopping immediately.

IN USE describe persistent discomfort

intermittent

Occurring at intervals rather than continuously.

IN USE describe intermittent pressure

sensitivity

Reported discomfort or response to contact, without a diagnosis.

IN USE record reported sensitivity

scalp

Skin covering the head beneath the hair.

IN USE distinguish scalp from neck

support adjustment

Change to a support, subject to appropriate assessment.

IN USE request a support adjustment review

positioning

How the client is placed, not a prescription made by this exercise.

IN USE refer a positioning concern

lead stylist

Senior salon colleague handling the relevant service concern.

IN USE contact the lead stylist

reassurance

Supportive communication that should not become an unsupported safety guarantee.

IN USE offer measured reassurance

agreed next step

Specific action the client and staff have confirmed.

IN USE state the agreed next step

Precision check

Keep permission specific: yes to a comfort check does not mean yes to the wash. Do not prescribe a new position, dismiss the sensation as normal, or promise that changing the support will resolve an unknown cause.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE PROMPTLY

"Thank you for telling me; we will pause here."

ASK FOR LOCATION

"Where are you feeling the pressure?"

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"I cannot determine the cause from that description."

ASK PERMISSION FOR REVIEW

"Would you like me to ask Noor to review the comfort concern?"

CONFIRM THE SERVICE STATE

"The water has not started."

USE THE CLIENT'S DESCRIPTION

"You feel pressure where your neck meets the support."

KEEP THE PAUSE EXPLICIT

"Preparation remains paused while we check."

NAME THE NEXT PERSON

"Noor is the lead stylist handling this check."

Feels versus is

Feels uncomfortable reports experience; is injured asserts a condition not established here.

Pause versus cancel

A pause stops the current action without automatically ending every future service.

Before

Before water starts fixes the sequence and prevents an inaccurate incident account.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE CONSENT

"Agreeing to the check does not mean restarting the wash."

PRESERVE THE REPORT

"I will pass on your description in your own terms."

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

"Is the pressure at that contact point what you want me to report?"

CONFIRM THE BOUNDARY

"We have not agreed to resume yet."

AVOID MINIMIZATION

"I will not assume the discomfort is something you should tolerate."

AVOID PRESCRIBING MOVEMENT

"I will not tell you to change position without the appropriate check."

AVOID A GUARANTEE

"We have not established what will resolve it."

CLOSE THE IMMEDIATE EXCHANGE

"The next step is the comfort check, with the wash still paused."

Permission scope

Permission for review applies to review, not every later action.

Client wording

Specific reported pressure is more accurate than an invented medical label.

No minimization

Polite reassurance should not pressure a client to continue through discomfort.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report is factual?

- A** Sam describes pressure at the back of the neck against the support.
- B** Sam has a diagnosed neck injury.
- C** The wash caused the condition.
- D** The support adjustment will certainly cure it.

2. Which action is agreed?

- A** Ask Noor for a comfort check while the wash stays paused.
- B** Restart water because Sam agreed to speak.
- C** Prescribe a particular neck angle.
- D** Treat the concern as resolved without review.

3. Which reassurance overreaches?

- A** I will report the pressure you described.
- B** This is definitely harmless, so we can carry on.
- C** Thank you for telling me.
- D** We will pause preparation.

4. Which chronology is accurate?

- A** Discomfort was reported before water started.
- B** Discomfort followed a completed wash.
- C** Water had been running for ten minutes.
- D** The appointment had ended before the report.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Pause before the wash

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

agreed next step / pause / consent / lead stylist / resume / Discomfort / contact point / water / client report / comfort check

- 01 **Sam:** Before you start the water, can we stop for a moment? The support under my neck feels uncomfortable, and I do not want to ignore it.
- 02 **Imani:** Of course. I will ¹ _____ preparation here. Thank you for telling me before the water starts; we can clarify the concern without beginning the wash.
- 03 **Sam:** It is pressure at the back of my neck, right where it rests against the support. I am not sure how else to describe it.
- 04 **Imani:** That description is useful. The ² _____ between your neck and the support is where you feel the pressure, rather than somewhere else on your head. Is that correct?
- 05 **Sam:** Yes, that is the spot. I do not know whether it is the support itself or how I am positioned, and I do not want to guess.
- 06 **Imani:** We do not need to guess the cause. I can arrange a ³ _____ with Noor, our lead stylist, while keeping the wash paused.
- 07 **Sam:** Please do. I do not want to hold everyone up, but I would feel better having it checked before anything continues.
- 08 **Imani:** You are not agreeing to ⁴ _____ by asking for the check. We will keep those decisions separate rather than treating your agreement to speak with Noor as permission to restart.
- 09 **Sam:** Thank you. I was worried that saying yes to the check might mean the water would start while we were still discussing it.
- 10 **Imani:** No. The ⁵ _____ has not started, and preparation remains paused. The immediate next step is to pass your concern to Noor, not begin washing.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Sam:** Could you say exactly where I feel it? If you just say I am uncomfortable, Noor may not understand what I was trying to explain.
- 12 **Imani:** I will preserve your ⁶ _____: pressure at the back of your neck where it meets the support. I will not add a diagnosis or a cause you have not stated.
- 13 **Sam:** That is right. I do not want it described as an injury when I have not said that and no one has assessed it.
- 14 **Imani:** Agreed. ⁷ _____ is what you have reported. I cannot determine the cause from this conversation or promise that one adjustment will resolve it.
- 15 **Sam:** Should I move, or is it better to wait until Noor comes over? I do not want to make another assumption about the position.
- 16 **Imani:** I will ask the ⁸ _____ to review that concern through our salon process. I will not prescribe a position or tell you to tolerate the pressure without the appropriate check.
- 17 **Sam:** All right. Please make sure the message says that I have agreed to the check but have not agreed to continue the wash yet.
- 18 **Imani:** I will state that ⁹ _____ clearly. You agree to Noor reviewing the comfort concern, and we have not agreed to restart the water or the wash.
- 19 **Sam:** Yes, that is exactly what I mean. I appreciate being able to explain it without feeling that I have to keep the appointment moving.
- 20 **Imani:** The ¹⁰ _____ is the comfort check, with your description passed on accurately. We will keep the pause in place while that concern is reviewed.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. pause | 2. contact point | 3. comfort check | 4. resume | 5. water | 6. client report | 7. Discomfort | 8. lead stylist | 9. consent | 10. agreed next step

Report discomfort without adding a diagnosis

F Say it

Before water starts, a client reports pressure behind the neck against the support. Preparation is paused. The client agrees to a comfort review with lead stylist Jo but has not agreed to resume.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pressure / started / resume / review

Assistant: "The reported sensation is ¹ _____."

Client: "The water has not ² _____."

Assistant: "The agreed next step is a comfort ³ _____."

Client: "I have not agreed to ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. pressure | 2. started | 3. review | 4. resume

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

What does forty-five include?

A Read the situation

Explain an optional service, compare complete totals, and confirm a client choice before adding anything.

Client Aisha believes the advertised \$45 haircut includes a finish. Stylist Ben explains that this fictional menu lists the haircut at \$45 and an optional finish at \$15, with no other charges in the exercise. Neither service has begun. The complete choices are \$45 for the haircut only or \$60 for both services. Aisha asks whether buying a styling product is required; Ben confirms it is not part of either quoted service choice. Aisha chooses the haircut only, with no finish or retail product added.

PEOPLE / Aisha: Client | Ben: Stylist

06

MAKE THE OPTIONAL PART GENUINELY OPTIONAL

Clients may assume a familiar service name includes the same elements everywhere. Explain the specific menu without implying they should have known. State the full comparison before seeking a choice, and do not let a product recommendation become an unrequested purchase.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the haircut-only total?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| A \$45 | B \$15 |
| C \$60 | D \$75 |

2. What is the complete combined total?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| A \$90 | B \$60 |
| C \$45 | D \$15 |

3. What does Aisha choose?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Haircut and finish | B A retail product instead of a haircut |
| C Both services without a price discussion | D Haircut only, with no finish or product added |

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service menu

List describing available services and their prices.

IN USE explain the service menu

base service

Main service before optional additions.

IN USE identify the base service

optional finish

Separately offered final styling service in this menu.

IN USE explain the optional finish

add-on

Additional item or service requiring agreement.

IN USE confirm an add-on

inclusive price

Price covering the specified listed elements.

IN USE clarify the inclusive price

combined total

Sum payable for the selected services together.

IN USE state the combined total

itemized price

Price shown separately for each component.

IN USE provide an itemized price

service inclusion

Element covered by a particular service description.

IN USE clarify service inclusions

service exclusion

Element not covered by the quoted service.

IN USE explain service exclusions

retail product

Product sold for the client to take away.

IN USE discuss a retail product

product recommendation

Suggested product, not an automatic purchase.

IN USE separate a recommendation from a sale

styling cream

Product category used to help shape or manage a style.

IN USE describe a styling cream

06

Precision check

The finish is optional and costs \$15 in addition to the \$45 haircut. Both services total \$60; the haircut-only choice remains \$45. There are no other charges in this fictional comparison, and no retail product is included.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

mousse

Foam-format styling product.

IN USE identify a mousse

gel

Gel-format product used for styling or hold.

IN USE describe a gel

pomade

Styling-product category often associated with shape, control, or sheen.

IN USE clarify a pomade preference

finishing spray

Spray product used as a finishing step, subject to client preference.

IN USE discuss finishing spray

hold

Degree of styling control claimed for a product.

IN USE compare hold descriptions

shine

Degree of visible sheen in a finish.

IN USE describe the shine

matte finish

Low-shine appearance in a product or style description.

IN USE clarify a matte finish

product claim

Statement made about a product's characteristics or effects.

IN USE check a product claim

purchase decision

Client's choice whether to buy an item.

IN USE confirm the purchase decision

service authorization

Permission to carry out the specified service.

IN USE confirm service authorization

price misunderstanding

Difference between what the client expected and what the menu includes.

IN USE resolve a price misunderstanding

charge confirmation

Read-back of the agreed amount and what it covers.

IN USE give a charge confirmation

Precision check

A recommendation is not a purchase decision. Product words such as hold, matte, and shine describe features to discuss; they do not establish suitability for every person or permission to add a product to the bill.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXPECTATION

"I understand you thought the finish was included."

IDENTIFY THE OPTIONAL ELEMENT

"The finish is an optional \$15 addition."

PRESERVE THE BASE CHOICE

"The haircut-only option remains \$45."

ASK BEFORE ADDING

"Would you like the finish added, or the haircut only?"

REFER TO THE SPECIFIC MENU

"On this menu, the haircut is \$45."

STATE THE COMBINED TOTAL

"Both services together would be \$60."

CLARIFY THE COMPARISON

"Those are the complete totals for these two choices."

SEPARATE RECOMMENDATION AND SALE

"A product recommendation does not add it to your purchase."

Includes versus costs extra

Includes places an element inside the price; costs extra marks a separate charge.

Optional

The client can decline without losing the stated base-service choice.

Together versus each

Together gives the combined total; each would imply separate equal amounts.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM NO PURCHASE REQUIREMENT

"Neither service choice requires a retail-product purchase here."

AVOID UNIVERSAL CLAIMS

"We need to check the actual product information and your preference."

RECORD THE EXCLUSIONS

"No finish or retail product will be added."

READ BACK THE CHARGE

"The agreed service is the haircut at \$45."

EXPLAIN A PRODUCT WORD

"Matte describes a lower-shine appearance."

CONFIRM THE DECISION

"You have chosen the haircut only."

RESOLVE WITHOUT BLAME

"Let us make the inclusions clear before we begin."

KEEP LATER CHANGES EXPLICIT

"We would confirm any later addition before proceeding."

06

Would be

This expresses the price of an option before it is chosen.

Recommendation versus authorization

Suggesting a product does not authorize sale or application.

No other charges

This is a supplied fictional fact, not a rule for every real salon price.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is complete?

- A** Finish \$15, with no base price mentioned.
- B** Both services \$45 because the client assumed so.
- C** Haircut only \$60 and finish extra.
- D** Haircut only \$45; haircut plus finish \$60.

2. Which question preserves a real choice?

- A** Shall I add the product because I mentioned it?
- B** Can we discuss the price after finishing?
- C** Would you like the \$60 combined option or the \$45 haircut only?
- D** You want the finish, do you not?

3. What does matte describe here?

- A** A guaranteed allergy-free product
- B** A mandatory purchase
- C** A fixed haircut length
- D** A lower-shine appearance

4. Which final read-back matches Aisha's decision?

- A** Haircut at \$45, with no finish or retail product added.
- B** Both services at \$60, plus an unpriced product.
- C** Finish only at \$15.
- D** Haircut and finish at \$45.

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

What does forty-five include?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

product recommendation / retail product / charge confirmation / matte finish / service menu / purchase decision / service authorization / combined total / base service / optional finish

06

- 01 **Aisha:** I thought the forty-five-dollar haircut included the finish. Before we start, can you explain what that price actually covers?
- 02 **Ben:** Of course. On this ¹ _____, the haircut is forty-five dollars, and the finish is listed separately as an optional fifteen-dollar addition.
- 03 **Aisha:** So if I have both, the final amount is not forty-five. I would like the complete number rather than just the extra amount.
- 04 **Ben:** The ² _____ for both services is sixty dollars. The haircut-only option is forty-five dollars, and those are the complete totals for these two choices.
- 05 **Aisha:** Thank you. I do not want to agree to the haircut and then discover that the finish was treated as something I had already accepted.
- 06 **Ben:** The ³ _____ is your choice. Neither service has begun, and I will confirm what you want before adding anything to the agreed plan.
- 07 **Aisha:** Can I just have the haircut today? I am keeping to a budget, and I would rather understand the basic option clearly.
- 08 **Ben:** Yes. The ⁴ _____ here is the haircut at forty-five dollars. Declining the finish does not remove that option or turn it into the sixty-dollar combined service.
- 09 **Aisha:** I also heard someone mention a styling product. Do I have to buy one to have the haircut-only option at that price?
- 10 **Ben:** No. A ⁵ _____ is not part of either quoted service choice, and neither requires a product purchase here. Discussing one does not mean adding it to your bill.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Aisha:** That is helpful. Sometimes a recommendation sounds like a requirement, especially when I do not know the difference between the product names.
- 12 **Ben:** We can keep the ⁶ _____ separate from the service decision. You can ask about a feature without agreeing to buy anything.
- 13 **Aisha:** For example, what does matte mean? I have seen it on products, but I am not sure whether it describes strength or something else.
- 14 **Ben:** A ⁷ _____ describes a lower-shine appearance. Hold is a different feature, and the actual product information matters when comparing what a particular item claims.
- 15 **Aisha:** So I can ask those questions now and still decide not to buy a product. I do not want anything automatically added today.
- 16 **Ben:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ is separate from the discussion. I will not add a product simply because we have talked about its description.
- 17 **Aisha:** Then please keep today to the haircut only, at forty-five dollars. No optional finish and no retail product for me.
- 18 **Ben:** I will record that ⁹ _____: haircut only at forty-five dollars, with no finish or retail product added. We have clarified the choice before either service begins.
- 19 **Aisha:** Yes, that is correct. I am glad we checked, because I would have felt awkward questioning the price after the service was finished.
- 20 **Ben:** Let me give the final ¹⁰ _____: forty-five dollars for the haircut. Any later addition would need its own clear discussion and agreement; nothing extra has been selected today.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. service menu | 2. combined total | 3. optional finish | 4. base service | 5. retail product | 6. product recommendation | 7. matte finish | 8. purchase decision | 9. service authorization | 10. charge confirmation

Compare another optional service

F Say it

A fictional menu lists a haircut at \$50 and an optional finish at \$20, with no other charges. The client chooses the haircut only and declines a retail product. Nothing has begun.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

optional / selected / seventy / fifty

Stylist: "Both services would total ¹ _____ dollars."

Client: "My haircut-only choice is ² _____ dollars."

Stylist: "The finish is ³ _____."

Client: "No retail product is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. seventy | 2. fifty | 3. optional | 4. selected

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The left side looks longer

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a specific result concern, separate appearance from confirmed findings, and arrange review before promising a remedy.

At checkout, client Mei says the left side of the haircut looks longer. Receptionist Rafael hears that the earlier consultation promised an even outline. The current appearance has not been reviewed together with stylist Jo. Rafael pauses checkout and offers a mirror review with Jo. Mei accepts the review. No cause has been established, and neither a correction nor a refund has been approved. The conversation must not turn a reported concern into a confirmed cutting error, a promise to remove more hair, or an automatic payment resolution.

PEOPLE / Mei: Client | Rafael: Receptionist

07

ACKNOWLEDGE WITHOUT DECIDING THE FINDING

You can take a concern seriously without declaring either that the client is mistaken or that the stylist made an error. Repeat the observable concern, arrange a specific review, and keep the client informed about what has and has not been agreed.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Mei report?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--|
| A The left side looks longer | B The right side has already been corrected |
| C A refund has been approved | D The stylist has confirmed the cause |

2. What was the earlier agreed expectation?

- | | |
|--|-----------------------------------|
| A No discussion of the outline | B An even outline |
| C A deliberately uneven outline | D A shorter left side only |

3. What is accepted now?

- | | |
|---|----------------------------------|
| A A confirmed fault diagnosis | B A mirror review with Jo |
| C Immediate removal of more hair | D An approved refund |

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

result concern

Client's question or dissatisfaction about the service outcome.

IN USE acknowledge a result concern

even outline

Outer edge intended to look balanced in length.

IN USE review the even outline

apparent difference

Difference that seems visible before assessment confirms details.

IN USE describe the apparent difference

left side

Client's left-hand side, clarified from the client's perspective.

IN USE identify the left side

right side

Client's right-hand side, distinguished from a mirror image.

IN USE compare the right side

mirror review

Joint examination of the appearance using a mirror.

IN USE arrange a mirror review

hand mirror

Portable mirror used to show another view.

IN USE offer a hand mirror

viewing angle

Direction from which the result is being seen.

IN USE clarify the viewing angle

client perspective

The client's view or orientation, important for side references.

IN USE confirm the client perspective

reported expectation

What the client says was agreed earlier.

IN USE record the reported expectation

consultation note

Record of preferences and agreed service details.

IN USE check the consultation note

assessment finding

Conclusion reached through the relevant review.

IN USE distinguish an assessment finding

Precision check

Mei reports that the left side looks longer; no joint review has confirmed a cause or cutting error. The earlier expectation was an even outline. Acknowledging both facts does not authorize removing more hair.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cause

Reason for the apparent difference, not yet established.

IN USE avoid inventing a cause

correction

Additional work intended to address a confirmed concern.

IN USE discuss a proposed correction

remedy

Proposed response to a service concern.

IN USE clarify the proposed remedy

rework consent

Permission for specifically described additional service work.

IN USE confirm rework consent

refund request

Client's request for money to be returned.

IN USE record a refund request

refund approval

Authorized decision to return money under the relevant process.

IN USE distinguish refund approval

checkout pause

Temporary stop in the payment process while a concern is addressed.

IN USE confirm the checkout pause

service record

Record of what was discussed and performed.

IN USE review the service record

acknowledgment

Clear recognition that the concern has been heard.

IN USE give a specific acknowledgment

defensive response

Reply focused on resisting criticism rather than addressing the concern.

IN USE avoid a defensive response

premature conclusion

Finding stated before the evidence or review supports it.

IN USE avoid a premature conclusion

resolution status

Current stage of handling the concern.

IN USE state the resolution status

Precision check

Keep the next step distinct from the outcome. A mirror review is accepted, checkout is paused, and no correction or refund is approved. Further work requires a specific explanation and the relevant agreement, not an assumption that review implies consent.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE SPECIFICALLY

"I hear that the left side looks longer to you."

PAUSE THE TRANSACTION

"Let us pause checkout while we address the concern."

AVOID A FINDING TOO SOON

"We have not reviewed the appearance together yet."

CLARIFY ORIENTATION

"Do you mean your left side as you are sitting here?"

RECOGNIZE THE EXPECTATION

"You were expecting an even outline."

AVOID DISMISSAL

"I will not assume it is just your imagination."

OFFER A CONCRETE NEXT STEP

"Would you like a mirror review with Jo?"

PRESERVE THE WORDING

"I will pass on that it looks longer, not that a cause is confirmed."

07

Looks versus is

Looks longer reports perception; is longer asserts a confirmed comparison.

Your left

Clarifies orientation when a mirror or another person's viewpoint could confuse sides.

Review versus redo

Review examines the issue; redo implies additional service work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE REVIEW AND CORRECTION

"Agreeing to review does not authorize more cutting."

KEEP PAYMENT STATUS ACCURATE

"No refund has been approved."

CHECK THE RECORD

"We can refer to the consultation note during the review."

KEEP THE CLIENT INVOLVED

"Any proposed further work should be explained before agreement."

AVOID A REMEDY PROMISE

"No correction has been approved yet."

INVITE THE RELEVANT EXPLANATION

"Jo can review the concern against the agreed outline."

CONFIRM THE ACCEPTED STEP

"You would like the mirror review first."

CLOSE WITHOUT PREMATURE RESOLUTION

"The review is the next step; the concern is not yet resolved."

Acknowledge versus admit

Acknowledging a concern does not automatically establish a fault finding.

Request versus approval

A requested refund and an authorized refund have different statuses.

First

First sequences review before any proposed remedy rather than guaranteeing a later outcome.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is most useful?

- A** I will remove more hair immediately.
- B** I hear that the left side looks longer and that you expected an even outline.
- C** It cannot be uneven because our stylist is experienced.
- D** The stylist definitely cut it incorrectly.

2. Which statement confuses review with consent?

- A** Checkout is paused.
- B** Jo will review the concern.
- C** No refund is approved yet.
- D** Agreeing to the mirror review means we can cut more without asking.

3. Which handover is accurate?

- A** Client approved a refund.
- B** Client withdrew the concern.
- C** Client reports a longer-looking left side; joint review pending.
- D** Cutting error confirmed and fixed.

4. Which next step has been accepted?

- A** Immediate correction of both sides
- B** Closing the complaint as resolved
- C** Mirror review with Jo before deciding a remedy
- D** Automatic refund before review

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The left side looks longer

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

client perspective / reported expectation / refund approval / apparent difference / checkout pause / assessment finding / result concern / resolution status / mirror review / rework consent

07

- 01 **Mei:** Before I pay, could someone look at the left side? It looks longer than the right, and we agreed on an even outline.
- 02 **Rafael:** Thank you for telling me. I hear the ¹ _____, and I understand that an even outline was the expectation discussed before the service.
- 03 **Mei:** Yes. I am not trying to be difficult, but I do not want to leave and then feel I should have said something while I was here.
- 04 **Rafael:** Let us put a ² _____ in place while we address it. I can ask Jo, your stylist, to review the appearance with you.
- 05 **Mei:** That would help. I want to show the exact part I mean rather than have the message passed on simply as a complaint about the haircut.
- 06 **Rafael:** We can arrange a ³ _____ so you can point it out directly. Would you like that review with Jo before we discuss any possible next action?
- 07 **Mei:** Yes, please. I am pointing to my left side as I sit here. I know the mirror can make the direction confusing.
- 08 **Rafael:** Thank you for clarifying the ⁴ _____. I will say your left side, rather than relying on which side appears on my left when I face you.
- 09 **Mei:** I also want Jo to know that the outline was supposed to look even. That was the part we discussed during the consultation.
- 10 **Rafael:** I will include that ⁵ _____. The concern should be reviewed against what was agreed, not treated as a new request for an unrelated style.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Mei:** Do you think it actually is longer, or could it be the way I am looking at it? I do not want anyone guessing.
- 12 **Rafael:** We have not established an ⁶ _____ yet. I can acknowledge what you see without deciding the cause before you and Jo review it together.
- 13 **Mei:** That is fair. Please do not promise to cut more off before Jo has explained what is being proposed. I might not want that.
- 14 **Rafael:** Absolutely. Your agreement to review is not ⁷ _____. Any proposed further work should be explained and agreed separately before anything is done.
- 15 **Mei:** And if I ask about a refund afterward, would that already have been approved by pausing checkout, or is that a separate discussion?
- 16 **Rafael:** That is separate. No ⁸ _____ has been given, and I do not want to imply that it has. Right now, the accepted next step is the mirror review.
- 17 **Mei:** Good. Please keep the message factual: it looks longer to me, I expected an even outline, and I want to review it with Jo first.
- 18 **Rafael:** I will record the ⁹ _____ in those terms. I will not say the cause is known, a correction is agreed, or the matter is already resolved.
- 19 **Mei:** Thank you. That gives us a clear way to look at it without anyone becoming defensive or making decisions before I understand them.
- 20 **Rafael:** The current ¹⁰ _____ is review pending, with checkout paused. We will keep you involved in any proposal that follows rather than treating the review itself as the remedy.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. result concern | 2. checkout pause | 3. mirror review | 4. client perspective | 5. reported expectation | 6. assessment finding | 7. rework consent | 8. refund approval | 9. apparent difference | 10. resolution status

Keep a second result concern factual

F Say it

A client says the right side looks fuller than expected. An even outline was agreed. A mirror review with stylist Kai is accepted. Checkout is paused; neither further cutting nor a refund is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

even / review / right / approved

Reception: "The reported concern is the ¹ _____ side."

Client: "We agreed on an ² _____ outline."

Reception: "The accepted next step is a mirror ³ _____."

Reception: "No refund is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. right | 2. even | 3. review | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Requested is not booked

A Read the situation

Hand over confirmed preferences, an unbooked consultation request, and photography permission as separate facts.

Stylist Sora is handing client details to receptionist Jordan. The client requested a future color consultation but has not booked it or accepted a date. Confirmed preferences from today are retained front length and no finishing spray. No agreement to promotional photographs is recorded. Sora and Jordan must preserve those distinctions when updating the record: a preference is not a booking, a request is not an accepted appointment, and participation in a salon service does not establish permission to use an image for promotion.

PEOPLE / Sora: Stylist | Jordan: Receptionist

08

PASS ON STATUSES, NOT CONVENIENT ASSUMPTIONS

A quick handover can accidentally turn interest into a booking or silence into agreement. Label each item according to what the client actually said. Read back the pending request and confirmed preferences separately so the next colleague does not have to reconstruct the conversation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What future service is requested?

A A promotional photograph session

C A completed color treatment

B A color consultation, not yet booked

D A confirmed appointment date

2. Which preferences are confirmed?

A Any future color formula

C Retained front length and no finishing spray

B Unlimited promotional photography

D Shorter front length and extra spray

3. What is the photography status?

A Permission covers every future use

C No promotional-photo agreement is recorded

B The client approved a campaign

D Consent is implied by visiting

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

client profile

Record of relevant client information and preferences.

IN USE update the client profile

preference note

Recorded choice about how the client wants a service handled.

IN USE preserve a preference note

front-length retention

Keeping the specified hair length toward the face.

IN USE confirm front-length retention

no-spray preference

Request not to use finishing spray.

IN USE record the no-spray preference

consultation request

Expression of interest in a consultation, not a confirmed appointment.

IN USE record the consultation request

pending booking

Appointment arrangement that is not yet confirmed.

IN USE distinguish a pending booking

accepted date

Appointment date the client has explicitly agreed to.

IN USE confirm the accepted date

follow-up contact

Later communication about an unresolved request.

IN USE arrange follow-up contact

handover

Transfer of relevant information and responsibility between colleagues.

IN USE give an accurate handover

read-back

Repetition of key details to confirm understanding.

IN USE perform a read-back

record amendment

Correction or update to an existing entry.

IN USE make a record amendment

service consent

Permission for a particular salon service.

IN USE distinguish service consent

08

Precision check

The color consultation is requested but unbooked. Retained front length and no finishing spray are confirmed preferences. No promotional-photo agreement is recorded. These three statuses should not be compressed into a vague statement that the client agreed to everything.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

image permission

Agreement concerning taking or using a person's image.

IN USE check image permission

promotional use

Use of material to advertise or market the salon.

IN USE clarify promotional use

portfolio image

Image displayed to demonstrate work, subject to appropriate permission.

IN USE discuss a portfolio image

publication channel

Place where content may be shared, such as a website.

IN USE specify a publication channel

permission scope

Exact action or use covered by an agreement.

IN USE confirm permission scope

recorded agreement

Agreement documented in the relevant record.

IN USE check the recorded agreement

unconfirmed assumption

Belief not supported by what the client has agreed.

IN USE remove an unconfirmed assumption

factual handover

Handover limited to accurate, relevant information.

IN USE provide a factual handover

open request

Request still awaiting a decision or arrangement.

IN USE track the open request

next contact owner

Person responsible for the next communication.

IN USE identify the next contact owner

status label

Word identifying whether an item is requested, pending, or confirmed.

IN USE use a precise status label

current record

Latest accurate version of the client information.

IN USE verify the current record

08

Precision check

Permission is purpose-specific. Do not infer promotional-image use from a completed service, a positive comment, or an unrecorded assumption. Use the actual salon process and applicable requirements for any later request involving taking or publishing images.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE HANDOVER

"I have two confirmed preferences and one unbooked request."

STATE THE SECOND PREFERENCE

"The client does not want finishing spray."

KEEP THE STATUS CLEAR

"The consultation is requested but not booked."

DISTINGUISH SERVICE AND IMAGE PERMISSION

"Service consent does not establish promotional-photo permission."

STATE THE FIRST PREFERENCE

"Please retain the front length."

NAME THE REQUESTED SERVICE

"The client requested a future color consultation."

AVOID INVENTING A DATE

"No appointment date has been accepted."

STATE THE RECORD ACCURATELY

"No promotional-photo agreement is recorded."

08

Requested versus booked

Interest or a request does not establish an accepted appointment.

Retain versus remove

Retain means keep the specified length rather than shorten it.

No spray

This is a product-use preference, not permission for every other product.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PREVENT AN ASSUMPTION

"Please do not mark that request as confirmed."

CORRECT A STATUS

"That should say requested, not booked."

KEEP FOLLOW-UP LIMITED

"Follow-up will address availability, not assume acceptance."

CONFIRM THE RECORD

"The profile should preserve these exact distinctions."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Can you repeat the confirmed preferences and pending request?"

ASSIGN THE NEXT CONTACT

"Who will handle the next booking discussion?"

KEEP THE DETAILS SEPARATE

"The no-spray preference is not a color-service decision."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Two preferences confirmed; consultation unbooked; photo agreement absent."

08

Recorded versus assumed

A documented agreement differs from a colleague's inference.

Purpose-specific permission

Agreement to a service does not automatically cover promotional use of an image.

Read-back

Repeating the status words catches errors that a general acknowledgment may miss.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** Consultation completed and date accepted.
- B** Spray approved unless the client objects again.
- C** Retain front length; no spray; color consultation requested but unbooked.
- D** Color treatment booked and product choices unrestricted.

2. What does no promotional-photo agreement recorded mean?

- A** A colleague can assume unlimited publication.
- B** The client approved every channel.
- C** Do not treat promotional use as authorized.
- D** Permission is automatic after a paid service.

3. Which label should replace an inaccurate booked entry?

- A** Paid in full
- B** Automatically renewed
- C** Requested, not booked
- D** Completed

4. Which read-back catches a meaningful error?

- A** I remember the client.
- B** We always do it this way.
- C** No date accepted; the consultation remains unbooked.
- D** Everything is fine.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Requested is not booked

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

no-spray preference / preference notes / read-back / consultation request / record amendment / next contact owner / Service consent / front-length retention / permission scope / booking status

08

- 01 **Sora:** Before you take over at reception, I want to pass on two confirmed preferences and one request that still needs a booking discussion.
- 02 **Jordan:** Go ahead. I will keep the ¹ _____ separate from the appointment status so an interest in a service does not accidentally become a confirmed booking.
- 03 **Sora:** The client wants the front length retained and does not want finishing spray. Those are the two preferences confirmed during today's conversation.
- 04 **Jordan:** I have ² _____ as the first preference. I will record it directly rather than summarizing it as a general request for a different haircut.
- 05 **Sora:** Thank you. Please keep the no-spray point equally clear. I do not want it lost inside a broad note that says the client likes a natural look.
- 06 **Jordan:** Agreed. The ³ _____ will be its own entry. A description of the desired look would not communicate that product-use choice as precisely.
- 07 **Sora:** The other point is a future color consultation. The client asked about arranging one, but we did not choose or agree on a date.
- 08 **Jordan:** Then that is a ⁴ _____, not a confirmed appointment. I will not mark a color service as booked merely because the client raised the idea.
- 09 **Sora:** Correct. It is a consultation request specifically, not an agreement to have color applied. The next conversation should address available appointments.
- 10 **Jordan:** I will leave the ⁵ _____ as unbooked. A later discussion can confirm a date, but the current record should not claim that has already happened.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Sora:** There is also a photography point. No agreement to promotional photographs is recorded, so please do not tell anyone that permission was given today.
- 12 **Jordan:** Understood. ⁶ _____ does not establish permission for promotional images. I will keep that distinction rather than assuming the visit itself covered photography.
- 13 **Sora:** Exactly. A positive comment about the appointment would not change that. Any later image request needs its own clear conversation through the salon process.
- 14 **Jordan:** The ⁷ _____ matters. We cannot turn an absent agreement into permission for a website, portfolio, or another promotional channel.
- 15 **Sora:** Could you read back the main points now? There are only a few, but the difference between requested and booked is easy to lose.
- 16 **Jordan:** My ⁸ _____ is: retain front length, no finishing spray, future color consultation requested but unbooked, and no promotional-photo agreement recorded.
- 17 **Sora:** That is correct. Please use those status words in the record, and keep the booking discussion separate from the product preference.
- 18 **Jordan:** I will make the ⁹ _____ accordingly. The no-spray preference does not select a color service, and the color request does not change the retained-length preference.
- 19 **Sora:** Good. Reception can handle the next discussion about availability, but please confirm the date with the client instead of treating an offered slot as accepted.
- 20 **Jordan:** Reception will be the ¹⁰ _____. We will discuss availability and seek confirmation, with the current record accurately showing two preferences, an unbooked request, and no photo agreement.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. preference notes | 2. front-length retention | 3. no-spray preference | 4. consultation request | 5. booking status | 6. Service consent | 7. permission scope | 8. read-back | 9. record amendment | 10. next contact owner

Read back a new client handover

F Say it

The client confirms retained side length and no finishing spray. A future styling consultation is requested but unbooked. Reception will handle the next availability discussion. No promotional-image agreement is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reception / unbooked / side / recorded

08

Stylist: "Please retain the ¹ _____ length."

Reception: "The consultation is requested but ² _____."

Stylist: "The next availability discussion belongs to ³ _____."

Reception: "No promotional-image agreement is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. side | 2. unbooked | 3. reception | 4. recorded

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Turning a reference photo into a clear request

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What practical feature matters to Alex?

D. Enough retained length for a low ponytail

Alex wants to retain practical length rather than copy the photograph exactly.

2. Which endpoint is agreed for the outline discussion?

B. Collarbone length

The clarification establishes collarbone length instead of the reference's chin-length endpoint.

3. What is the fringe status?

B. No fringe is requested

Alex explicitly confirms that the fringe in the reference is not requested.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which read-back preserves the agreement?

B. Collarbone-length outline, retain ponytail length, no fringe

The read-back includes the chosen length, practical requirement, and explicit fringe exclusion.

2. Which feature needs separate consent?

D. The straight fringe shown in the photo

A visible feature is not automatically requested merely because it appears in the reference.

3. What does trim fail to specify on its own?

B. The agreed amount or endpoint of length removal

Trim is imprecise unless the amount or resulting length is clarified.

4. Which promise is unsupported?

B. Every strand will definitely fit into a ponytail based only on this photo.

The reference does not establish how all of Alex's actual hair sections will tie back.

01 Conversation answers

Turning a reference photo into a clear request

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. reference photo.** Turn 2. Reference photo provides an idea to discuss, rather than automatic permission to copy every visible feature.
- 2. retained length.** Turn 4. Retained length names the hair Alex wants to keep for practical use, which can conflict with copying the shorter photograph.
- 3. collarbone-length.** Turn 6. Collarbone-length is the longer outline direction agreed for discussion, replacing the reference's chin-length endpoint.
- 4. low ponytail.** Turn 8. Low ponytail is the practical styling requirement Alex wants preserved while the outline and individual sections are discussed.
- 5. fringe.** Turn 10. Fringe names the front feature in the photograph, also called bangs, which Alex explicitly does not request.
- 6. visual feature.** Turn 12. Visual feature means a particular visible aspect of the style; naming it helps confirm whether the client wants it.
- 7. outline.** Turn 14. Outline describes the haircut's outer shape, not an automatic instruction to remove the same amount from every section.
- 8. agreed plan.** Turn 16. Agreed plan summarizes the confirmed direction: collarbone-length outline, retained ponytail length, and no fringe requested.
- 9. consent.** Turn 18. Consent applies to the specified agreed action, not every feature present in a reference image.
- 10. length removal.** Turn 20. Length removal is the amount to be cut off, which requires agreement rather than an assumption based on the style name.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. shoulder-length

Stylist: "The agreed outline is shoulder-length."

Shoulder length is the confirmed direction, not the reference's shorter endpoint.

2. front

Client: "Please retain the front length."

Front length is the specific feature the client wants preserved.

3. bangs

Stylist: "No bangs are requested."

Bangs are explicitly declined despite any appearance in the reference.

4. started

Client: "The cut has not yet started."

The brief places the clarification before any cutting begins.

02 Briefing and language checks

Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What does Morgan want at the neckline?

C. Less fullness

Morgan asks for reduced neckline fullness while separately declining exposed sides.

2. Which supplied photo shows covered sides?

B. Photo A

Photo A is described as retaining visible hair over the sides.

3. How much daily styling time does Morgan report?

B. Five minutes

The brief states five minutes as Morgan's current morning styling allowance.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which comparison is supported?

D. A shows covered sides; B shows exposed skin at the shortest area.

Only the supplied visible difference is established by the two photographs.

2. Which clarification best follows less bulk?

D. Where does the fullness bother you most?

The location question clarifies the requested change without inventing removal or exposure.

3. What remains unagreed?

D. The cutting method and exact length

The brief explicitly leaves the method and exact length unagreed.

4. Which summary preserves both preferences?

A. Reduce neckline fullness while retaining visible side coverage.

The correct summary keeps the desired reduction and the coverage boundary distinct.

02 Conversation answers

Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. neckline. Turn 2. Neckline identifies the lower boundary at the back where Morgan wants less fullness, separate from the side-coverage preference.

2. coverage. Turn 4. Coverage means hair remains visibly over the sides, which matches Morgan's stated preference in this comparison.

3. Exposed skin. Turn 6. Exposed skin is the feature Morgan declines; reducing fullness at the neckline does not authorize adding it at the sides.

4. visual comparison. Turn 8. Visual comparison anchors the discussion in observable features rather than assuming a style label has one identical interpretation everywhere.

5. bulk. Turn 10. Bulk refers to perceived fullness or weight in an area, here specifically near the collar rather than across the entire head.

6. styling routine. Turn 12. Styling routine describes the time and effort Morgan normally uses, which informs consultation without guaranteeing a particular result.

7. upkeep. Turn 14. Upkeep covers ongoing effort needed to maintain an appearance; it remains a discussion rather than an established five-minute guarantee.

8. growth pattern. Turn 16. Growth pattern is the direction or arrangement of natural hair growth, which must be assessed on the client rather than inferred from another person's photo.

9. appearance. Turn 18. Appearance describes the visible direction being discussed, without claiming an exact length or technical cutting method has already been agreed.

10. time budget. Turn 20. Time budget records Morgan's available styling time, not a promise that the proposed appearance will always take exactly five minutes.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. C

Barber: "The client prefers photo C."

C is the reference with the covered-side appearance the client chooses.

2. nape

Client: "The unwanted fullness is at the nape."

Nape identifies the specific location of the fullness concern.

3. ten

Barber: "The daily time budget is ten minutes."

Ten minutes is the reported allowance, not a guaranteed styling duration.

4. method

Client: "No cutting method has been agreed."

The brief leaves the technical method open despite the appearance preference.

03 Briefing and language checks

Discussing color without promising a photograph

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is booked today?

B. A consultation only

Today's booking is explicitly a consultation, not a color-service appointment.

2. Which history detail remains unknown?

A. The previous home-color product

Priya cannot identify the earlier product, so its identity remains unknown.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. The photographed result will be completed by Friday.

Neither suitability nor time has been established to support that deadline promise.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which explanation distinguishes level and tone?

D. Level is lightness or darkness; tone is color character.

The correct explanation separates two different dimensions of color description.

2. Which history entry is accurate?

A. Previous home-color product not identified.

The client reports prior use but cannot identify the product or category.

3. Which response handles the deadline accurately?

A. I understand Friday matters; we have not assessed whether that is achievable.

The response acknowledges the preference without replacing the pending assessment with a promise.

4. Which status should reception receive?

A. Consultation only; no color appointment booked.

The supplied facts establish only the consultation and an unbooked future service.

03 Conversation answers

Discussing color without promising a photograph

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. color consultation. Turn 2. Color consultation identifies today's booked discussion and assessment, not an appointment to perform the requested color service.

2. Tone. Turn 4. Tone describes the warm or cool character Priya likes, rather than the separate question of how light the color is.

3. level. Turn 6. Level refers to relative lightness or darkness, which remains a separate preference to clarify alongside the cool tone.

4. home color. Turn 8. Home color identifies the reported earlier product use without inventing its exact brand, category, or effects.

5. product identity. Turn 10. Product identity means the actual identifying information, which is more useful than guessing the category from a remembered package color.

6. Suitability. Turn 12. Suitability is whether the proposed service is appropriate after assessment; it has not been established by the reference or deadline.

7. service duration. Turn 14. Service duration is the time needed for the proposed service, which remains unassessed rather than guaranteed to fit before Friday.

8. cost. Turn 16. Cost has not been assessed because the service plan is not established; no quoted total is available from the supplied facts.

9. color goal. Turn 18. Color goal captures the desired cool-tone appearance without turning it into a selected formula, accepted price, or booked service.

10. booking status. Turn 20. Booking status distinguishes today's consultation from a future color appointment, which remains unbooked despite the client's preferred deadline.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. warmer

Colorist: "The requested tonal direction is warmer."

Warmer describes the desired color character in this new request.

2. unidentified

Client: "My previous product remains unidentified."

The product was used but its identity is still unknown.

3. consultation

Colorist: "Today is a consultation only."

The appointment covers discussion rather than an approved color service.

4. booked

Reception: "No future service is booked."

A desired result and event do not create a confirmed appointment.

04 Briefing and language checks

Booking time and handling appointment changes

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is the revised start based on the stated delay?

D. 2:20

Twenty minutes after the original 2:00 appointment gives a 2:20 start.

2. When would the ordinary forty-minute service finish?

A. 3:00

Adding forty minutes to 2:20 gives an ordinary finish of 3:00.

3. Which replacement does Luis choose?

C. Tomorrow at 10:00

The client chooses the available 10:00 appointment tomorrow as the replacement.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which explanation is accurate?

B. Starting at 2:20 would ordinarily finish at 3:00, after your departure deadline.

The calculation preserves the ordinary duration and shows the fifteen-minute conflict.

2. Why is the change fee waived here?

C. The salon's delay causes the rescheduling under its stated policy.

The brief gives a specific local policy and a salon-caused delay.

3. Which booking record is correct after acceptance?

D. Tomorrow 10:00 replaces today's appointment.

The accepted option is a replacement, not a second active appointment.

4. Which response should be avoided?

C. We will definitely compress the forty-minute service into twenty-five minutes.

No shortened service has been promised or established as feasible.

04 Conversation answers

Booking time and handling appointment changes

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. delay. Turn 2. Delay is the difference between the original 2:00 start and the revised 2:20 start, not the length of the haircut itself.

2. revised start. Turn 4. Revised start identifies 2:20 as the updated beginning, while the ordinary forty-minute service still has to follow.

3. service duration. Turn 6. Service duration is forty minutes; adding it to the revised 2:20 start produces a 3:00 ordinary finish.

4. departure deadline. Turn 8. Departure deadline is Luis's fixed latest leaving time of 2:45, which the ordinary revised schedule cannot meet.

5. availability. Turn 10. Availability means the 10:00 slot tomorrow can currently be offered; it becomes the replacement only after Luis chooses and confirms it.

6. fee waiver. Turn 12. Fee waiver means the salon does not charge the change fee in this salon-caused rescheduling; it is not a refund or universal rule.

7. replacement booking. Turn 14. Replacement booking means tomorrow's accepted appointment takes the place of today's slot rather than adding another active haircut booking.

8. booking record. Turn 16. Booking record holds the active appointment and change reason; updating it helps avoid conflicting reminders or duplicate active slots.

9. confirmation message. Turn 18. Confirmation message should state the actual date, 10:00 time, and haircut service so the client can verify the replacement details.

10. duplicate booking. Turn 20. Duplicate booking would leave two unintended active appointments; the accepted tomorrow slot replaces today's delayed appointment.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 2:00

Reception: "The ordinary finish would be 2:00."

Forty-five minutes after 1:15 gives an ordinary finish of 2:00.

2. ten

Client: "That is ten minutes after my departure deadline."

The ordinary 2:00 finish is ten minutes later than 1:50.

3. 9:30

Reception: "Tomorrow's replacement is at 9:30."

The client accepts the specific 9:30 alternative supplied in the brief.

4. waived

Reception: "The change fee is waived."

The stated policy removes this fee because the salon caused the delay.

05 Briefing and language checks

Checking comfort and pausing clearly

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What has not started?

B. The water and wash

The brief places the concern before water begins and before the wash starts.

2. Where does Sam describe pressure?

C. At the back of the neck against the support

Sam identifies the contact area at the back of the neck.

3. What does Sam agree to?

D. A comfort check, not restarting the wash

Consent is limited to the check; the wash remains paused.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which report is factual?

A. Sam describes pressure at the back of the neck against the support.

The correct statement preserves the client's reported sensation without assigning cause or diagnosis.

2. Which action is agreed?

A. Ask Noor for a comfort check while the wash stays paused.

The client consents to review only, with no agreement to restart.

3. Which reassurance overreaches?

B. This is definitely harmless, so we can carry on.

Harmlessness is not established, and the client has not agreed to continue.

4. Which chronology is accurate?

A. Discomfort was reported before water started.

The supplied sequence places the concern before water or washing begins.

05 Conversation answers

Checking comfort and pausing clearly

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. pause. Turn 2. Pause means stopping preparation now, not continuing while the client waits for someone to review the concern.

2. contact point. Turn 4. Contact point identifies where the neck touches the support, preserving the client's location description without inventing a cause.

3. comfort check. Turn 6. Comfort check is the agreed review of the reported concern before any decision about resuming the wash.

4. resume. Turn 8. Resume means begin the wash again; consent to a comfort check does not automatically authorize that separate step.

5. water. Turn 10. Water has not started, and the service remains paused during the requested comfort review.

6. client report. Turn 12. Client report means Sam's account of pressure at the back of the neck against the support, rather than a staff diagnosis.

7. Discomfort. Turn 14. Discomfort is the reported unpleasant sensation; it does not by itself establish injury, cause, or a medical condition.

8. lead stylist. Turn 16. Lead stylist identifies Noor as the colleague handling the salon comfort review, not as someone whose assessment has already occurred.

9. consent. Turn 18. Consent is limited to the comfort check, with separate agreement still needed before restarting the wash.

10. agreed next step. Turn 20. Agreed next step is the comfort review while preparation remains paused, not a promised adjustment or resumed service.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. pressure

Assistant: "The reported sensation is pressure."

Pressure is the client's description, not an inferred injury or diagnosis.

2. started

Client: "The water has not started."

The concern occurs before water begins, preserving the correct chronology.

3. review

Assistant: "The agreed next step is a comfort review."

Review is the action accepted by the client in this scenario.

4. resume

Client: "I have not agreed to resume."

Agreement to review does not authorize restarting the paused wash.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Explaining services, prices, and product choices

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is the haircut-only total?

A. \$45

The supplied menu sets the haircut alone at forty-five dollars.

2. What is the complete combined total?

B. \$60

The forty-five-dollar haircut plus the fifteen-dollar optional finish totals sixty dollars.

3. What does Aisha choose?

D. Haircut only, with no finish or product added

The final choice explicitly excludes the optional finish and retail product.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which comparison is complete?

D. Haircut only \$45; haircut plus finish \$60.

The correct comparison gives both complete totals using the supplied menu.

2. Which question preserves a real choice?

C. Would you like the \$60 combined option or the \$45 haircut only?

The question presents both priced options before any service begins.

3. What does matte describe here?

D. A lower-shine appearance

Matte concerns appearance, not safety guarantees, purchase requirements, or haircut length.

4. Which final read-back matches Aisha's decision?

A. Haircut at \$45, with no finish or retail product added.

The correct read-back preserves the selected base service and explicit exclusions.

06 Conversation answers

Explaining services, prices, and product choices

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. service menu. Turn 2. Service menu is the specific list governing this fictional price comparison; the client should not be expected to infer its inclusions from other salons.

2. combined total. Turn 4. Combined total adds the forty-five-dollar haircut and fifteen-dollar finish, giving sixty dollars with no other charges in the exercise.

3. optional finish. Turn 6. Optional finish is a separate service the client may accept or decline; it is not automatically authorized by choosing the haircut.

4. base service. Turn 8. Base service is the haircut alone at forty-five dollars, which remains available without the optional finish.

5. retail product. Turn 10. Retail product is a separate take-home purchase, not a required component of either quoted service choice in this scenario.

6. product recommendation. Turn 12. Product recommendation is a suggestion to discuss, not the client's authorization to buy or a condition of receiving the stated service.

7. matte finish. Turn 14. Matte finish describes a lower-shine appearance, not the degree of hold or a guarantee that a product suits every client.

8. purchase decision. Turn 16. Purchase decision belongs to the client and remains separate from asking questions or hearing a recommendation.

9. service authorization. Turn 18. Service authorization is limited to the haircut the client selects; it excludes the optional finish and any retail purchase.

10. charge confirmation. Turn 20. Charge confirmation repeats the agreed forty-five-dollar haircut and exclusions, resolving the original misunderstanding before work starts.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. seventy

Stylist: "Both services would total seventy dollars."

Fifty plus twenty gives the combined total of seventy dollars.

2. fifty

Client: "My haircut-only choice is fifty dollars."

The selected base service retains its fifty-dollar price without the finish.

3. optional

Stylist: "The finish is optional."

The client can decline the separately priced finish in this menu.

4. selected

Client: "No retail product is selected."

The client explicitly declines a product rather than authorizing an extra sale.

07 Briefing and language checks

Responding to a concern about the result

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does Mei report?

A. The left side looks longer

The concern is a reported visual difference that has not yet been reviewed.

2. What was the earlier agreed expectation?

B. An even outline

The consultation reportedly promised an even outline, making that expectation relevant to review.

3. What is accepted now?

B. A mirror review with Jo

Mei accepts the review while correction and payment decisions remain unapproved.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which opening is most useful?

B. I hear that the left side looks longer and that you expected an even outline.

The response acknowledges the specific concern and expectation without deciding cause or remedy.

2. Which statement confuses review with consent?

D. Agreeing to the mirror review means we can cut more without asking.

Consent to examine the result does not authorize additional cutting.

3. Which handover is accurate?

C. Client reports a longer-looking left side; joint review pending.

The handover preserves the reported appearance and unfinished review status.

4. Which next step has been accepted?

C. Mirror review with Jo before deciding a remedy

The brief confirms review only and leaves both correction and refund unapproved.

07 Conversation answers

Responding to a concern about the result

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. result concern. Turn 2. Result concern is Mei's reported longer-looking left side, which should be acknowledged without immediately deciding whether a cutting error occurred.

2. checkout pause. Turn 4. Checkout pause means temporarily stopping the payment process to address the concern, not approving a refund or declaring the service resolved.

3. mirror review. Turn 6. Mirror review is the specific accepted next step for examining the visible concern with Jo before any remedy is decided.

4. client perspective. Turn 8. Client perspective fixes left and right relative to Mei, avoiding confusion caused by the receptionist's viewpoint or the mirror.

5. reported expectation. Turn 10. Reported expectation is the even outline Mei says was agreed, which is relevant to review without proving the current cause or finding.

6. assessment finding. Turn 12. Assessment finding would follow the relevant review; the conversation currently contains a reported appearance rather than a confirmed cause.

7. rework consent. Turn 14. Rework consent would authorize specifically described additional work; accepting a mirror review alone does not give that permission.

8. refund approval. Turn 16. Refund approval is an authorized payment decision, which has not occurred simply because checkout is paused or a review is accepted.

9. apparent difference. Turn 18. Apparent difference describes how the result looks to Mei without changing the report into a confirmed cutting error or diagnosis of cause.

10. resolution status. Turn 20. Resolution status is review accepted and pending, checkout paused, with no correction or refund approved and no final outcome established.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. right

Reception: "The reported concern is the right side."

The client identifies the right side in this new scenario.

2. even

Client: "We agreed on an even outline."

Even outline is the earlier expectation relevant to the review.

3. review

Reception: "The accepted next step is a mirror review."

Review is accepted, while a particular remedy has not been authorized.

4. approved

Reception: "No refund is approved."

Pausing checkout and reviewing the concern do not establish refund approval.

08 Briefing and language checks

Passing preferences to the next appointment

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What future service is requested?

B. A color consultation, not yet booked

The client requested a consultation but has not selected or accepted an appointment.

2. Which preferences are confirmed?

C. Retained front length and no finishing spray

The brief confirms only the two stated service preferences.

3. What is the photography status?

C. No promotional-photo agreement is recorded

No explicit agreement has been recorded, so permission must not be assumed.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Retain front length; no spray; color consultation requested but unbooked.

The correct handover preserves both confirmed preferences and the unbooked request.

2. What does no promotional-photo agreement recorded mean?

C. Do not treat promotional use as authorized.

Absence of a recorded agreement does not supply permission for promotional use.

3. Which label should replace an inaccurate booked entry?

C. Requested, not booked

Requested reflects the client's interest without inventing an accepted date.

4. Which read-back catches a meaningful error?

C. No date accepted; the consultation remains unbooked.

The specific read-back verifies the unresolved booking status rather than offering a vague acknowledgment.

08 Conversation answers

Passing preferences to the next appointment

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. preference notes. Turn 2. Preference notes hold the client's confirmed front-length and no-spray choices, separate from the future consultation request.

2. front-length retention. Turn 4. Front-length retention means keeping the specified front length, not shortening it or treating the preference as a complete future haircut instruction.

3. no-spray preference. Turn 6. No-spray preference explicitly records that finishing spray is not wanted; a vague description of appearance could omit that product-use boundary.

4. consultation request. Turn 8. Consultation request records interest in arranging the future discussion, not an accepted appointment or authorization for a color treatment.

5. booking status. Turn 10. Booking status remains unbooked because no date has been accepted, even though the client has expressed a clear request.

6. Service consent. Turn 12. Service consent concerns the salon service and does not automatically grant permission to take or use photographs for promotion.

7. permission scope. Turn 14. Permission scope is the specific use covered by an agreement; no promotional-photo agreement is present in the current record.

8. read-back. Turn 16. Read-back repeats the exact preferences and statuses so Sora can catch any changed meaning before the handover ends.

9. record amendment. Turn 18. Record amendment is the accurate update preserving the confirmed preferences and unbooked request, not a change to what the client has authorized.

10. next contact owner. Turn 20. Next contact owner identifies who will handle the later availability discussion while leaving acceptance and booking still pending.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. side

Stylist: "Please retain the side length."

The confirmed retained-length preference concerns the sides in this new case.

2. unbooked

Reception: "The consultation is requested but unbooked."

No accepted appointment has been established by the request alone.

3. reception

Stylist: "The next availability discussion belongs to reception."

Reception is explicitly assigned the next contact in the supplied handover.

4. recorded

Reception: "No promotional-image agreement is recorded."

The record contains no agreement authorizing promotional image use.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Turning a reference photo into a clear request

Open the reference: Which features of this photograph do you like?

Ask about daily use: Do you need to be able to tie it back?

Record the exclusion: No fringe is requested.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Describing shape, texture, and everyday styling

Name the priority: You want less fullness at the neckline.

Describe the contrast: Photo B exposes skin in its shortest area.

Record the time limit: You have about five minutes each morning.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Discussing color without promising a photograph

Clarify the attraction: Is it the cool tone or the lighter level that you like?

Set today's scope: Today is a consultation only.

Acknowledge the deadline: I understand you would prefer it before Friday.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Booking time and handling appointment changes

Acknowledge the delay: I am sorry; your appointment is running twenty minutes late.

State the ordinary duration: We normally allow forty minutes for this service.

Offer a concrete alternative: We have 10:00 tomorrow available.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Checking comfort and pausing clearly

Acknowledge promptly: Thank you for telling me; we will pause here.

Use the client's description: You feel pressure where your neck meets the support.

Name the next person: Noor is the lead stylist handling this check.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Explaining services, prices, and product choices

Acknowledge the expectation: I understand you thought the finish was included.

State the combined total: Both services together would be \$60.

Separate recommendation and sale: A product recommendation does not add it to your purchase.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Responding to a concern about the result

Acknowledge specifically: I hear that the left side looks longer to you.

Avoid dismissal: I will not assume it is just your imagination.

Preserve the wording: I will pass on that it looks longer, not that a cause is confirmed.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Passing preferences to the next appointment

Open the handover: I have two confirmed preferences and one unbooked request.

Name the requested service: The client requested a future color consultation.

State the record accurately: No promotional-photo agreement is recorded.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

accepted date	confirm the accepted date	68
acknowledgment	give a specific acknowledgment	60
add-on	confirm an add-on	50
agreed next step	state the agreed next step	42
agreed plan	repeat the agreed plan	6
apparent difference	describe the apparent difference	59
appointment slot	confirm the appointment slot	32
ash	discuss an ash tone	23
assessment finding	distinguish an assessment finding	59
availability	check tomorrow's availability	32
back length	confirm back length	6
balayage	clarify balayage expectations	24
bangs	explain bangs	5
base color	clarify the base color	23
base service	identify the base service	50
basin	refer to the basin	41
blend	discuss the blend	14
blunt outline	describe a blunt outline	6
bob	clarify the bob outline	5
booking record	update the booking record	33
bulk	clarify unwanted bulk	14
calendar date	confirm the calendar date	33
cancellation	record the cancellation	32
cause	avoid inventing a cause	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

change fee	explain the change fee	33
charge confirmation	give a charge confirmation	51
checkout pause	confirm the checkout pause	60
chin length	distinguish chin length	5
client perspective	confirm the client perspective	59
client profile	update the client profile	68
client report	preserve the client report	41
collarbone length	confirm collarbone length	5
color consultation	book a color consultation	23
color correction	assess color correction	24
color goal	clarify the color goal	23
color history	review color history	23
combined total	state the combined total	50
comfort check	arrange a comfort check	41
confirmation message	send a confirmation message	33
consent	confirm service consent	6
consent to continue	ask for consent to continue	41
consultation	conduct a consultation	5
consultation note	check the consultation note	59
consultation request	record the consultation request	68
contact point	identify the contact point	41
cool tone	identify a cool tone	23
correction	discuss a proposed correction	60
coverage	retain side coverage	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

cowlick identify a cowlick	15
crown identify the crown	15
current record verify the current record	69
defensive response avoid a defensive response	60
delay explain the delay	32
demi-permanent color clarify demi-permanent color	24
density assess hair density	15
departure deadline respect the departure deadline	32
discomfort acknowledge discomfort	41
duplicate booking avoid a duplicate booking	33
estimated finish calculate the estimated finish	32
even outline review the even outline	59
exposed skin avoid exposed skin	14
face-framing discuss face-framing	6
factual handover provide a factual handover	69
fade compare fade references	14
fee waiver apply the fee waiver	33
finish compare the finish	15
finishing spray discuss finishing spray	51
follow-up contact arrange follow-up contact	68
fringe clarify the fringe	5
front length protect front length	6
front-length retention confirm front-length retention	68
fullness reduce neckline fullness	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

gel describe a gel	51
golden identify golden tones	23
growth pattern discuss the growth pattern	15
hairline describe the hairline	15
hand mirror offer a hand mirror	59
handover give an accurate handover	68
highlights discuss highlights	24
hold compare hold descriptions	51
home color identify previous home color	23
image permission check image permission	69
inclusive price clarify the inclusive price	50
intensity clarify reported intensity	42
intermittent describe intermittent pressure	42
itemized price provide an itemized price	50
late arrival distinguish a late arrival	33
layers discuss layers	6
lead stylist contact the lead stylist	42
left side identify the left side	59
length removal confirm length removal	6
level discuss the color level	23
lightener discuss a lightener service	24
location clarify the location	42
low ponytail retain low-ponytail length	5
low taper clarify the low taper	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

matte finish clarify a matte finish	51
mirror review arrange a mirror review	59
mousse identify a mousse	51
nape identify the nape	14
natural texture discuss natural texture	15
neck support check the neck support	41
neckline discuss the neckline	14
next contact owner identify the next contact owner	69
no-show clarify the no-show category	33
no-spray preference record the no-spray preference	68
notice period explain the notice period	33
onset ask about onset	42
open request track the open request	69
optional finish explain the optional finish	50
outline confirm the outline	5
parting identify the parting	6
pause keep the wash paused	41
pending booking distinguish a pending booking	68
perimeter discuss the perimeter	5
permanent color distinguish permanent color	24
permission scope confirm permission scope	69
persistent describe persistent discomfort	42
pomade clarify a pomade preference	51
portfolio image discuss a portfolio image	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

positioning refer a positioning concern	42
preference note preserve a preference note	68
premature conclusion avoid a premature conclusion	60
preparation pause preparation	41
pressure describe the pressure	41
price misunderstanding resolve a price misunderstanding	51
product claim check a product claim	51
product identity confirm product identity	24
product recommendation separate a recommendation from a sale	50
promotional use clarify promotional use	69
publication channel specify a publication channel	69
purchase decision confirm the purchase decision	51
read-back perform a read-back	68
reassurance offer measured reassurance	42
record amendment make a record amendment	68
recorded agreement check the recorded agreement	69
reference photo discuss the reference photo	5
refund approval distinguish refund approval	60
refund request record a refund request	60
regrowth discuss visible regrowth	23
remedy clarify the proposed remedy	60
replacement booking confirm the replacement booking	32
reported expectation record the reported expectation	59
reschedule reschedule the haircut	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

resolution status state the resolution status	60
result concern acknowledge a result concern	59
resume confirm before resuming	41
retail product discuss a retail product	50
retained length preserve retained length	5
revised start confirm the revised start	32
rework consent confirm rework consent	60
right side compare the right side	59
salon-caused delay acknowledge the salon-caused delay	33
scalp distinguish scalp from neck	42
scheduled start state the scheduled start	32
semi-permanent color discuss semi-permanent color	24
sensitivity record reported sensitivity	42
service allocation preserve the service allocation	33
service authorization confirm service authorization	51
service consent distinguish service consent	68
service duration state the service duration	32
service estimate provide a service estimate	24
service exclusion explain service exclusions	50
service inclusion clarify service inclusions	50
service menu explain the service menu	50
service record review the service record	60
shine describe the shine	51
side length compare side length	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

sideburn clarify sideburn length	15
skin fade identify the skin fade	14
status label use a precise status label	69
straight fringe identify the straight fringe	5
strand thickness distinguish strand thickness	15
styling cream describe a styling cream	50
styling routine describe the styling routine	15
suitability assess service suitability	24
support adjustment request a support adjustment review	42
taper discuss a taper	14
temporary color identify temporary color	24
time conflict identify the time conflict	32
tone clarify the tone	23
toner clarify a toner service	24
transition describe the transition	14
trim clarify the trim	6
unconfirmed assumption remove an unconfirmed assumption	69
upkeep discuss upkeep	15
viewing angle clarify the viewing angle	59
visual comparison make a visual comparison	15
visual feature identify a visual feature	6
waitlist explain the waitlist	33
warm tone describe a warm tone	23
wash station identify the wash station	41

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Barbers, Hairstylists, and Cosmetologists.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for consultations, service records, styling, payment, and client communication. The original cases are not transcripts of real appointments. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] US Food and Drug Administration. Cosmetics Safety Q&A: Hair Dyes.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for the importance of current warnings, instructions, and required checks. This book gives no dye formulas, testing steps, or treatment advice. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Wella. Hair Levels and Tones.

[Open the original source](#)

Manufacturer terminology distinguishing lightness or darkness from warm or cool tonal character. No brand numbering system or product recommendation is taught. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Hair Salons.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for checking actual salon-product information and hazards rather than relying on a familiar product name or marketing claim. Checked 1 October 2026.

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